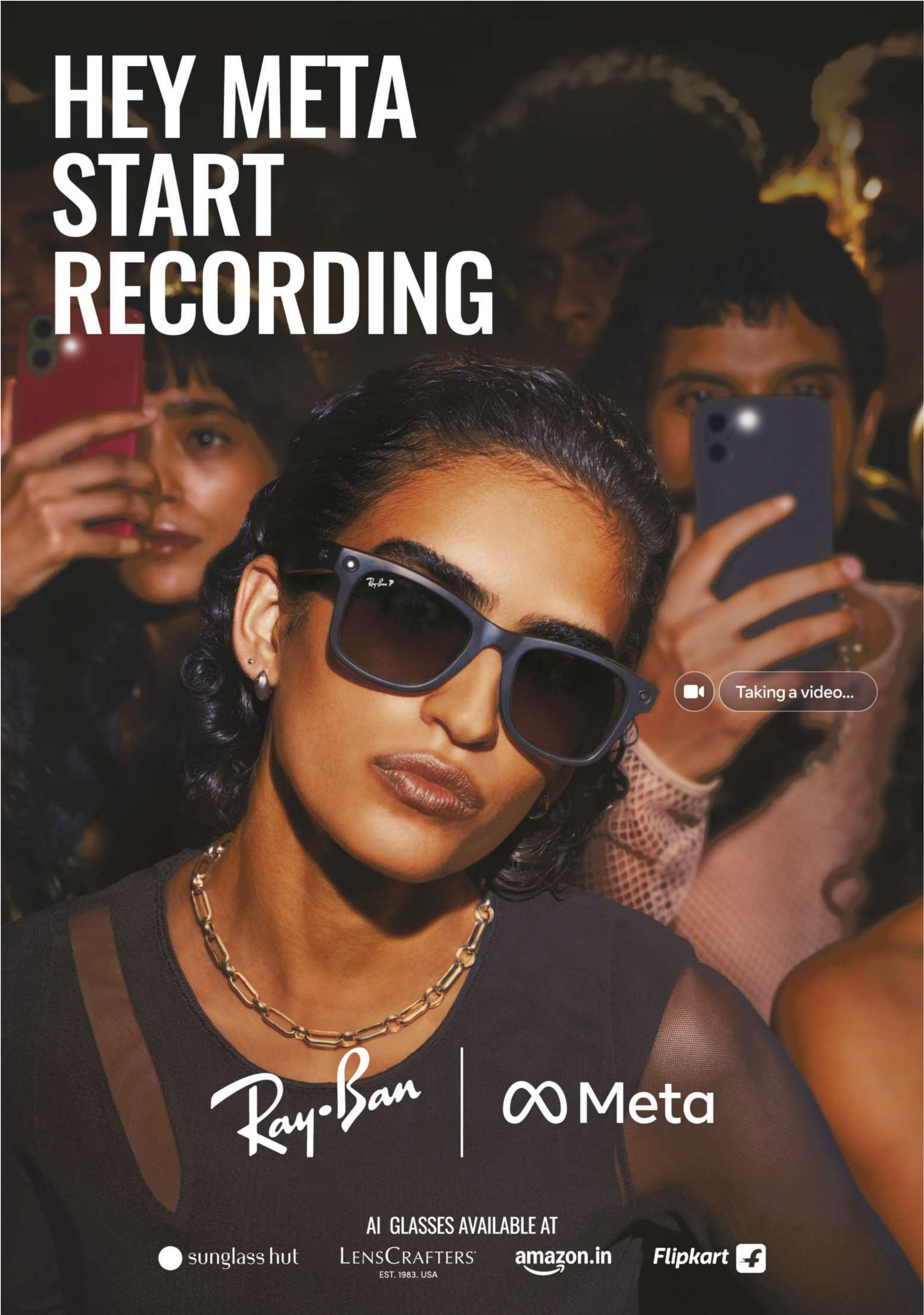


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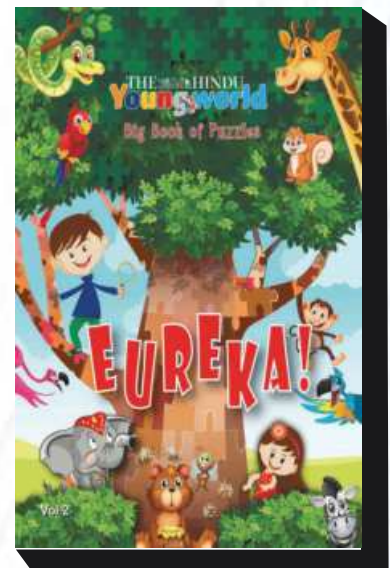
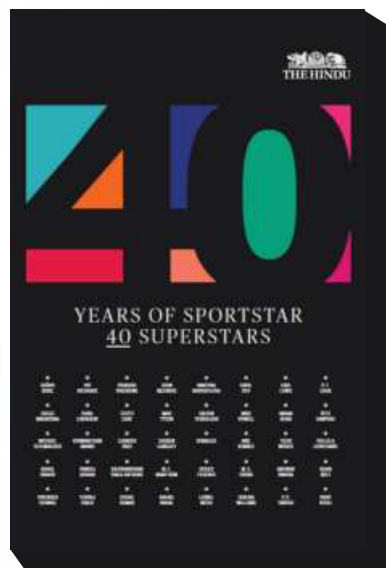
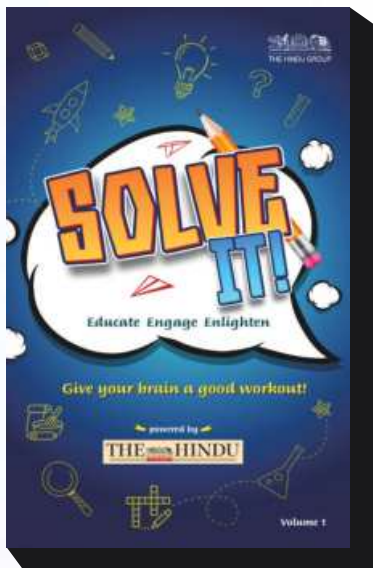
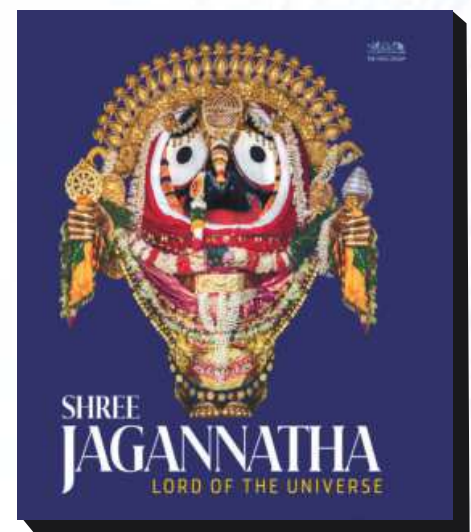
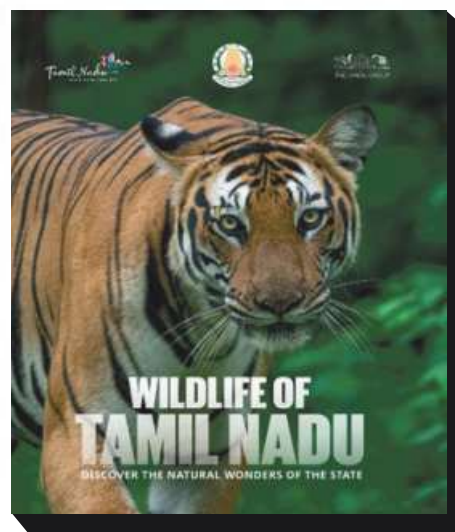
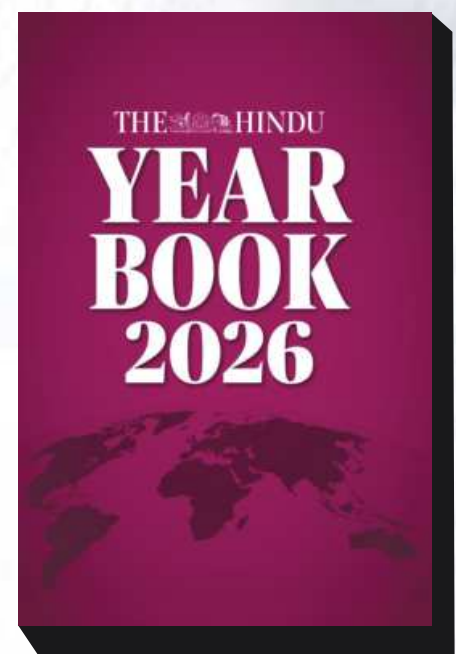
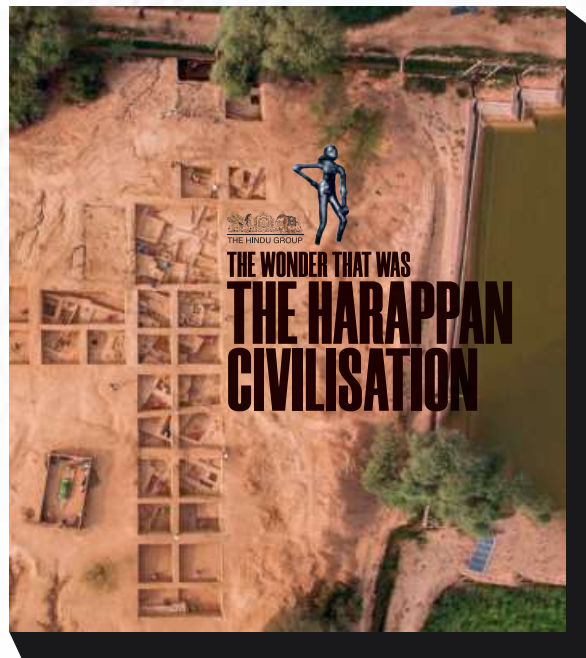
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INBRIEF



Food Minister reviews Civil Supplies CID's functioning

Food and Civil Supplies Minister P. Venkataramanan on Tuesday conducted a review meeting at the Civil Supplies CID. He issued instructions on measures to prevent smuggling and hoarding offences related to Public Distribution System commodities and essential goods. Director-General of Police of the Civil Supplies CID G. Venkataraman, and other officials participated in the meeting.

Three migrant workers held for misbehaving with women

Sushil Ghaini, Jansal, and Karthik, migrant workers from Nepal who are residents of Vellalar Street in Purasawalkam, were arrested for behaving inappropriately with two women, when they were walking on the street in the locality on Tuesday. The arrested were later remanded in judicial custody.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (June 3, Wednesday), the following articles are available:

■ The future of India's chip industry newsth.live/semiconductorindustry

■ Regulatory gaps leave Indians at risk from chronic aircraft noise newsth.live/noiseregulation

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

'Fill specialist vacancies in rural hospitals through upcoming counselling'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Service Doctors and Post Graduates Association (SDPGA) has requested the Director of Medical and Rural Health Services (DMS) and the Director of Public Health and Preventive Medicine to fill specialist vacancies in DMS institutions by displaying the vacancies in the upcoming counselling for medical officers recruited through the Medical Services Recruitment Board (MRB).

Deputation and diversion

In a statement, SDPGA president P. Saminathan said there were a number of government hospitals with less than eight doctor posts in various districts functioning under the DMS and providing round-the-clock services by deputation and diversion of doctors. A sizeable number of government hospitals under the DMS still have vacant posts of specialists, leading to further shortage and difficulties in running 24-hour services.

In this situation, the directorates should display the specialist vacancies in DMS institutions during the upcoming counselling on June 4 and fill them, the association added.

Timings
CHENNAI

WEDNESDAY, JUN. 03		
RISE	05:42	SET 18:33
RISE	21:11	SET 07:51
THURSDAY, JUN. 04		
RISE	05:42	SET 18:33
RISE	21:56	SET 08:43
FRIDAY, JUN. 05		
RISE	05:42	SET 18:33
RISE	22:38	SET 09:35

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	38	26
Chennai Airport	40	26
Chennai City	39	30

Chennai Airport Today
40°C The weather will be hot and uneasy with moderate winds. Night will also be uneasy. Spell of light rain and thundershowers may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
39°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be hot and uneasy. Night will also be uneasy. Mostly dry weather to prevail.

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Smoke from sulphur stored at port causes discomfort to people in surrounding areas

Officials said the high temperature caused the incident. Air monitoring carried out by the TNPCB after the incident registers a rise in the levels of particulate matter, nitrogen dioxide, and ammonia

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Heavy smoke rose from the stocks of sulphur stored in one of Chennai Port's yards on Tuesday morning, engulfing the surrounding areas and causing discomfort to residents and commuters, sources said.

Around 11 a.m., smoke began rising from the sulphur powder, which had been imported by one of the firms to use as a fertilizer component. "Due to the high temperature, the sulphur particles in the yard began to produce heavy smoke. This does occur during summer. The situation has been brought under control now. No one was injured in the incident," a source said.

Three fire tenders were rushed to the yard as soon as the dense smoke was spotted, and the firefighters brought the situation under control. But the smoke quickly spread to neighbouring areas, and those in the vicinity complained of discomfort, cough, and irritation in the eyes.

V. Dhanashree, a lawyer at the Madras High Court,



Airborne hazard: The white smoke that was seen on Kamarajar Salai near the Secretariat on Tuesday.

said that as soon as she stepped out of the court hall, she saw the smoke and subsequently advocates and people on the premises started coughing.

"A little while later, I could feel irritation in my eyes, and all of us were left wondering where the smoke was coming from. Many of us started worrying. Then, we were told about the incident at the port. The authorities should have been more careful and prevented this from happening. We hope

they take action to ensure something like this doesn't occur again," she said.

Air monitoring carried out after the incident showed a spike in particulate pollution around the area. Officials of the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board (TNPCB) said levels of PM2.5, PM10, nitrogen dioxide, and ammonia were higher than usual following the incident.

Officials added that while these pollutants could degrade air quality, significant health impacts

were associated only with sustained exposure over longer periods, and the leak today was contained swiftly.

Adequate precautions

An expert at IIT-Madras said the temperature had been very high these past few days. "Knowing the nature of Sulphur, the authorities should have taken some steps to avoid this incident. Smoke from sulphur can irritate the eyes and lungs as well," the expert added.

TAMIL NADU HOUSING BOARD
Special Project Division-1.

NOTICE

It is hereby informed that the Special Project Division-1 of Tamil Nadu Housing Board office has been shifted from the existing No.C-48, 1st Floor, Anna Nagar, 2nd Avenue Road, Chennai - 600040, Tamil Nadu Housing Board Office Building to the following new address due to administrative reasons. Accordingly, the office is being functioned in the following address with effect from 13.05.2026.

New Address:
Office of the Executive Engineer & Ado.,
Special Project Division-1, No.18 (9),
Tamil Nadu Housing Board Head Quarters Office Building,
5th Floor, B-Wing, 1st Main Road, C.I.T Nagar, Chennai – 600 035.

Therefore, all concerned allottees, general public and contractors are kindly requested to contact the office at the above new address for all matters relating to the Special Project Division-1 here after.

Contact No : 99404 98968.

Executive Engineer & Ado., (I/c.),
Special Project Division-1.
DIPR/478/Display/2026

Govt. of Bihar

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ADDENDUM TO ADVERTISEMENT
Regarding Invitation of Applications for appointment of Vice-Chancellors in the Select Universities of Bihar.

In continuation of the advertisements issued for appointment of Vice-Chancellors in the Universities listed below, the following addendum is hereby issued:

- The applications were initially invited through the portal <https://app.gsbihar.online/>, with the last date for submission originally notified as 20th June 2026, and the same were widely published in State and National newspapers on 20th May 2026 vide PR no. 003692/26-27 and 003693/26-27
- With a view to ensuring wider outreach and facilitating participation from a larger pool of eligible candidates across the country, the Competent Authority has decided that applications **shall also be accepted** through the **SAMARTH Portal**.
- In this regard, it is clarified that:
 - Applications received through either of the two portals shall be considered for the selection process.
 - However, candidates are required to submit their application through only one portal. Hence, those who have already applied through the existing portal, need not apply again.
- The last date for submission of applications is hereby extended to 30th June 2026 up to 06:00 PM. Applications received after the due date or found incomplete shall not be considered.
- The advertisement, application format, and detailed guidelines are available on the website of the Governor's Secretariat, Bihar. (<https://governor.bih.nic.in/>)
- Candidates are required to apply online either through:
 - <https://vcrec.samarth.ac.in>
 - or
 - <https://app.gsbihar.online/>
- The eligibility criteria and general instructions remain same.

Sl. No.	Name of Universities
1.	Aryabhatta University, Patna
2.	L.N. Mithila University, Darbhanga
3.	Kameshwar Singh Darbhanga Sanskrit University, Darbhanga
4.	Bhupendra Narayan Mandal University, Madhepura
5.	BRAB University, Muzaffarpur
6.	Jai Prakash University, Chapra

(Dipak Kumar Singh)
Add. Chief Secretary to Governor-cum-Chancellor, Bihar Lok Bhavan, Patna, Bihar

This information is available on www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar also

PR. No. 004884 (Governor) 2026-27

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I, Amrita Yogesh Mirpuri, R/o. 1D Bijayati Towers, 72 Halls Rd, Kilpauk, Chennai-10, have changed my name to Amrita Mirpuri.

I, GIVEN Name: Gowri Parmita (Old Name) D/o: Elankumaran, aged 18 years (15.05.2008), residing at No. 42, Kamatchi Amman Samadhi Street, Kanchipuram Town & District - 631502. Shall henceforth be known as Given name: Gowri Parmita Surname: Elankumaran (New Name) - Given Name: Gowri Parmita. Date: 03.06.2026, Place: Kanchipuram

I, Roshni Goyal W/O, Ankush Agarwal S R/o 173/141, Evr Lane, Ph Road, Kilpauk, Chennai 600010 have changed my name to Roshni Agarwal.

I, RASANEHI Hitesh (Old Name), s/o R. Venkatanagulu, residing at 20-3-13, Flat No. 201, Akhil Residency, Siva Jyothi Nagar, Tirupati, Andhra Pradesh, have changed my surname from Rasanehi to Rasineni and shall henceforth be known as Rasineni Hitesh (New Name) vide Affidavit Stamp No. 59AA 498203 dated 01-06-2026 at Tirupati.

I, Sunil Kumar Singh S/o Rambriksh Singh, DOB 02.05-1974, have lost my B.Tech (Computer Science & Engineering) marksheet & degree certificate issued by HPT (now HBTU) Kanpur. If found, pls contact me @9940326820

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Vacant government land in MMDA Mathur turns into dump yard

Residents say that they dump waste on the vacant land to avoid foul smell near their homes and allege that garbage collection is irregular

CITY MATTERS

Karishma Jambukeswaran
CHENNAI

A vacant government-owned plot near Third Cross Street in MMDA Mathur has turned into a dumping ground, with residents from nearby localities regularly disposing garbage there.

Residents said they leave for work early in the morning, before conservancy workers arrive for door-to-door garbage collection, prompting them to dump the waste on the open ground. “If we leave the garbage bags outside our houses, cows and dogs pull them apart and create a mess on the streets,” said S. Benjamin, 43, a resident.

“If a new conservancy worker is deployed, the waste bags remain untouched for days. Due to ongoing drainage work in the locality, it has become difficult to hand over waste directly to conservancy workers. They do not arrive at a fixed time every day, and if residents are unavailable when they come, the waste just stays where we left it,” he added.

Several residents said they dump waste on the vacant land before leaving for work to avoid foul smell



Polluted space: The vacant plot near Third Cross Street in MMDA Mathur, where garbage is dumped regularly. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Waste collectors say many fail to leave garbage bags outside their homes

near their homes. However, garbage collectors said residents had repeatedly been advised to keep their waste outside their homes for collection, but many failed to follow the instructions. “We end up cleaning the vacant plot every day,” said a conservancy worker assigned to the area.

Bins removed
A Manali zonal official of the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) said bins were previously placed in the locality but were removed following com-

plaints about waste accumulating around them. He added that conservancy workers cleared the open ground every day.

‘Will erect signboards’
When asked about signboards warning against dumping, the official said although they were installed earlier, people continued to litter in the area. New signage will be put up, he said. The official added that green nets would be installed around the area to prevent waste from being thrown into the building behind the site.

Awareness campaigns would also be conducted, and steps would be taken to gradually reduce dumping and prevent accumulation of waste on the site.

This is the time to create an ideal environment for media freedom: N. Ravi

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government, with many of its members proficient in media and communications, should consider the time crucial to create an ideal environment for media freedom and free speech, N. Ravi, Chairman, Chennai Institute of Journalism (CIJ), and Director, Kasturi and Sons Limited, said on Tuesday.

“Chief Minister Vijay, apart from his other qualities, is proficient in visual communication, and the Minister for Information is a prominent media personality. This is the time to create an ideal environment for media freedom and for free speech in general,” Mr. Ravi said, speaking at the first convocation of the Chennai Institute of Journalism.

Quoting former Supreme Court Judge, Justice Vivian Bose, he said that the “effect of words must be judged from the standards of reasonable, strong-minded, firm, and courageous men and not those of weak and vacillating minds and of those who smell danger in every hostile point of view”, clarifying that the expression ‘men’ included women as well.

“Actually, there must be a great deal of tolerance of criticism, however harsh or unreasonable, and any action in the case of free speech should be in line with the Constitutional



Information Minister Rajmohan handing over a certificate to a student at the convocation of the Chennai Institute of Journalism on Tuesday, in the presence of N. Ravi, Director, Kasturi and Sons Limited. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

limitations provided in Article 19(2).” Mr. Ravi emphasised.

While the rise of social media has democratised and widened the access to media space, absence of trained gatekeepers has pushed factual accounts, fairness, and informed opinion to the backseat. “It is in this context of the proliferation of the media, both mainstream and social, that the training imparted by institutions such as the CIJ becomes significant,” he pointed out.

Rajmohan, Minister for School Education, Tamil Development, and Information, in response to Mr. Ravi, quoted Voltaire to state that he believed that irrespective of political differences, the right to free speech should be defended.

“Whatever be the differences, this government will be pro-people and, as has been the established practice, will stand united on people’s issues,” Mr. Rajmohan stated.

A.S. Panneerselvam, Di-

rector General, Chennai Institute of Journalism, said that it was the State government’s involvement that had made it possible to offer a well-curated post-graduate diploma course in journalism with a fully equipped lab and domain experts teaching the students for a mere ₹10,000 annual tuition fee. The primary aim of the institute was to ensure that fees should not be an entry barrier for students.

The Minister, during his address, assured Mr. Panneerselvam of the government’s continued support to good initiatives like the CIJ.

A total of 39 students from the first batch received their certificates with T. Anbudasan and V. Arathi receiving Outstanding Student Awards and P. Surender receiving the Skill Proficiency award.

V. Rajaraman, Secretary, Tamil Development and Information, and A. Arun Thamburaj, Director, Information and Public Relations, also spoke.

INBRIEF



Minimally invasive brain surgery performed on girl

Rela Hospital performed a rare cerebral micro-arteriovenous malformations (AVMs) surgery on a 16-year-old girl without opening the skull. The brain surgery was performed through a tiny puncture in her thigh. The surgery was performed on a school student from Tiruvallur district after she was diagnosed with micro-AVMs through cerebral digital subtraction angiography (DSA). A surgical team, led by Muralidharan Vetrivel, consultant neurosurgeon, cerebrovascular and neuro-oncology, performed the surgery. “Following the surgery, which lasted only one hour and forty-five minutes, the girl was ready to resume her usual activities, after taking necessary rest,” Dr. Muralidharan said.



Three persons arrested for smuggling ganja from A.P.

The Prohibition Enforcement Wing, Ambattur, has arrested three persons for smuggling ganja from Andhra Pradesh. The police identified the arrested as Gokul, 25, and Muthukumaran, 22, both natives of Thanjavur, and Mustafa, 26, of Vellore. They were intercepted near the Korattur railway station during regular surveillance. A search led to the seizure of 21 kg of ganja. An inquiry revealed that they had allegedly procured the contraband from the neighbouring State to sell in the city.

Ilaiyaraaja is integral to Manjanathi, says director Mari Selvaraj

B. Kolappan
CHENNAI



Award-winning director Mari Selvaraj’s next film, *Manjanathi*, with music by maestro Ilaiyaraaja, is not centred on a single woman character but on women portrayed by three actors. The story’s title was originally part of a series published in the Tamil magazine *Ananda Vikatan*.

“Whenever the name Manjanathi came to my mind, I thought of adapting it into a film. Even then, I had decided that maestro Ilaiyaraaja should compose the music. When I met him and narrated the story, he agreed to score it,” said Mari Selvaraj, who participated in the programme to mark 50 years of Ilaiyaraaja’s entry into film a few days ago and spoke about the film and how the long-cherished dream had come true. Ilaiyaraaja invited him to the dais and asked him to share his experience.

Asked whether the story revolves around Manjanathi, the titular character, Mr. Mari Selvaraj told *The Hindu*, the film features many women characters.

“It is a film about women, their feelings, emotions, and aspirations. The core of the story is about women. The narrative begins in the southern districts, where the name Manjanathi is more common. But I have treated the subject in a fresh manner, and the audience will find it surprising,” he said.

Talking about his experience of working with Ilaiyaraaja, he said they had only just begun. “He keeps me happy. I went to meet him with a little fear, but he has given me confidence. I

The film may release in December this year, or may spill over to January 2027.

I wrote the script completely with Ilaiyaraaja in mind, says Mari Selvaraj

wrote the script completely with Ilaiyaraaja in mind. The way I have approached the subject and integrated him into the film will be new to cinema. The audience will understand why I chose Ilaiyaraaja when the film is released. It is not just about the songs; he is part and parcel of the film,” he added.

Though Mari Selvaraj is aiming to release the film by December this year, the release may spill over to January 2027.

The film stars Kathir in the lead role. He had earlier played the eponymous role in Mari Selvaraj’s acclaimed film *Parierum Perumal*. The director has also elevated Ponvel, who played Sivananainjan in *Vaazhai*, to the status of a second hero in the film.

The female leads include Kayadu Lohar, Priyanka Arul Mohan and a newcomer, who has not been finalised.

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
Tender Notice No.: DRMENGGRNC-38-2026, Dated: 01.06.2026, Divisional Railway Manager (Engg), South Eastern Railway, Ranchi-834003 for & on behalf of President of India, invites Tender for the following work:
Notice No.: DRMENGGRNC-38-2026
Name of work: Chandli-Muri-Barkakana (SL) Section: Conversion of stone-set bridges (18 nos.) into RCC Box bridges with flat top under the jurisdiction of DEN (East) Ranchi. **Tender Value:** ₹ 10.69, 12,424.48. **EMD Value:** ₹ 21.38,300. **Tender closing date & time:** 25.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs. Tenderers can visit the website www.iरेps.gov.in for online tendering. (PR-263)

CENTRAL RAILWAY CORRIGENDUM-1
Tender No. 51.26.6080 Dept./Rly. Stores/Central Railway Closing: 17.06.2026 at 11:30 am. **Tender Title:** Running Contract for Manufacture and supply of 6400mm Thick. **Field Name :** Tender opening Date/Time, **Tender No. 51.26.6080, Existing Date :** 03.06.2026 11:30, **Modified Date :** 17.06.2026 11:30 **DE/223**
TRAVEL SAFELY, AVOID FOOTBOARD TRAVELLING

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
Chennai Division
No. M-TRD-294-OT-2026-27-04R DL.01.06.2026
For and on behalf of the President of India, the Divisional Railway Manager/Traction Distribution Branch, Chennai Division, Southern Railway, Chennai - 3, invites online tender from the experienced Contractors for the following works for further details, please refer to www.iरेps.gov.in

Sl.No.	Tender No. / Name of the work	Value (Rs.)	Closing date/time
1.	M-TRD-294-OT-2026-27-04R Modification to existing OHE arrangements due to Realignment of curves for increasing speed to 130 kmph in Chennai Division.	5,60,60,845.60	23.06.2026 (15:00 hrs)

Divisional Railway Manager
Traction Distribution Branch, Chennai Division, Chennai-3

Indian Overseas Bank
PUBLIC RELATION DEPARTMENT
Central Office: 763, ANNA SALAI, CHENNAI-600002
Indian Overseas bank (IOB) invites bids for the following:
GOVERNMENT E-MARKET PORTAL – ENGAGEMENT OF PUBLIC RELATION AGENCY
BID NO: GEM/2026/B/7608458
DATED 01.06.2026
The Above GEM Tender document is also available and can be downloaded from the following websites www.iob.bank.in & www.gem.gov.in For Tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following website www.gem.gov.in

OPPORTUNITIES

Over 45 Jobs in today’s issue

GENERAL

काशी हिन्दू विश्वविद्यालय
An Institution of National Importance established by an Act of Parliament
INVITATION OF APPLICATIONS FOR DR. S.R. RANGANATHAN INTERNSHIP IN BHU LIBRARIES
Banaras Hindu University (BHU) conducts an ambitious Dr. S.R. Ranganathan Internship programme in BHU Libraries, in memory of Dr. S.R. Ranganathan, a doyen in the field of Library Science and who worked as Librarian of Sayaji Rao Gaekwad Library in its formative years. A total number of 12 internships are available under this program for the year 2026-27 intake. The internship program will be of one-year duration, extendable for one more year based on the performance of the intern. The interns will get a monthly stipend of ₹20,000.00. For full details and application format, interested candidates are requested to visit the University website: www.bhu.ac.in The last date to receive the duly filled application forms is June 21, 2026.
Deputy Registrar
SRICC

VAAGDEVI
INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE TECHNOLOGY AND RESEARCH
(Proposed Deemed to be University under Distinct Category under section 3 of the UGC Act,1956)
(Sponsored by Viswambhara Educational Society)
Hunter Road, Rangasai Pet, Khila Warangal (Mandal)
Warangal, Telangana-506005, India
Applications are invited for the post of VICE-CHANCELLOR
The Honourable Chancellor of Vaagdevi Institute of Science Technology and Research has constituted a Search-cum -Selection Committee to recommend a suitable candidate from amongst experienced and distinguished academicians who meet the qualifications and experience as prescribed in the UGC(Institutions Deemed to be Universities) Regulations,2023 read with the UGC regulations, 2018. **Eligibility:** The candidate shall be a distinguished academicians with a minimum of ten years of experience as Professor in a University system, or ten years of experience in reputed research and /or academic administrative organization, with proof of having demonstrated academic leadership. The candidate shall possess the highest level of competence, integrity, institutional commitment and proven governance, strategic management & leadership abilities, and shall be visionary in the holistic growth of the Organization. The tenure and age limit and other criteria shall be as per the UGC norms.
Interested candidates are required to email their detailed curriculum along with educational qualifications, experience, research publications, administrative roles, and a digital photograph to recruitment@vaagdevi.edu.in, info@vaagdevi.edu.in on or before 09.06.2026. A hard copy of the application along with supporting documents shall reach to “The Secretary & Correspondent, Viswambhara Educational Society, Bollikunta, Waranagali-506005, Telangana” on or before 10.06.2026 by 5 pm, in an envelope superscribed “Application for the post of Vice-Chancellor Confidential”. For further information contact: 6281687733.
Date: 03.06.2026
Sd/-, Secretary and Correspondent

DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL BHILAI
Risali Sector, Bhilai, Chhattisgarh — 490006
(Under the aegis of The Delhi Public School Society, New Delhi)
REQUIRES PRINCIPAL
Candidates with a consistently strong academic record, with at least 55% marks in post-graduation, a B.Ed. degree and a minimum of 15 years of teaching experience in Senior Secondary classes in English medium that includes at least 5 years of experience in an administrative capacity (as Principal/Vice Principal only), are invited to apply.
The age of the candidate should not exceed 55 years as on 1st April, 2026.
Salary, perquisites and other benefits shall be as per the rules of The DPS Society. Higher emoluments will not be a constraint for a deserving candidate. National award winners in the field of education will be given preference.
Procedure for submitting applications :
1.Apply on-line by clicking ‘Application for the post of Principal’ at the ‘Careers’ section of website of DPS, Bhilai (<https://dpsbhilai.in>).
2.After successfully submitting the application on-line, take print-outs of the application that is sent to your e-mail, affix your recent passport-size photograph on it, enclose self-attested photocopies of certificates related only to your date of birth, qualifications, experience and national awards, if any, and post it to the following addresses :
a)The Secretary, The Delhi Public School Society, F-Block, East of Kailash, New Delhi-110065.
b)The Secretary, Steel Education Society (SES), Room No. 01, Office of Employee Services, Old Hospital Building, Sector-5, Bhilai – 490006.
c)Last date for submission of applications on-line is 15/06/2026.
d)Last date for receipt of hardcopy of applications at DPSS, New Delhi and SES, Bhilai, is 25/06/2026.
3.The envelope should be superscribed: ‘Application for the post of Principal, DPS Bhilai’
4.Incomplete or erroneous applications will be summarily rejected.
5.Please do not enclose any other document (like letters of appreciation, certificates of participation etc) with your application other than those specified above.
Only shortlisted candidates will be called for an interview.

GENERAL

Indian Overseas Bank
Tech-Perfect Solutions for the Nation’s Defence
BHARAT ELECTRONICS LIMITED
(A Govt. of India Enterprise under the Ministry of Defence)
(CIN: L32309KA1954G0000787)
SUB: CANCELLATION OF RECRUITMENT
Ref: Advertisement No:383/HR/MS/RECT/2025-26 dated 19.01.2026
It is notified for information of all concerned that the recruitment for the post of Deputy Manager for Missile System SBU of Bangalore Cx. vide Newspaper Advertisement (Hindi & English) released on 19.01.2026 and 21.01.2026 in (The Hindu +Dainik Jagran + Nai Dunia) and Website Advertisement No:383/HR/MS/RECT/2025-26 dated 19.01.2026 uploaded on our Company website has been cancelled.
The registration fee submitted by candidates will be refunded on receiving their duly filled in claim form. The detail of claim form is available on website: www.bel-india.in
Bharat Electronics Limited, Bangalore
‘Har Ek Kaam Desh Ke Naam’

HINDUSTAN SHIPYARD LIMITED
VISAKHAPATANAM - 530 005
(A Government of India Undertaking Ministry of Defence)
[Eighty Five Years of Service to the Nation]
REQUIRES
I. Permanent Absorption Basis:

Sl	Name of the Post	No. of posts	Category
P1	Manager(Technical) (E3)	05	01-UR; 03-SC; 01-ST
P2	Manager (HR) (E3)	02	01-UR; 01-SC
P3	Deputy Manager (Technical) (E2)	10	05-UR; 02-OBC; 02-SC; 01-ST

II. Fixed Term Contract Basis:

Sl	Name of the Post	No. of posts	Category
F1	Project Superintendent (Technical)	02	02-UR
F2	Dy. Project Superintendent (Technical) - Delhi Region	01	01-UR
F3	Dy. Project Officer (Technical)	05	02-UR; 02-OBC; 01-SC
F4	Dy. Project Officer (Civil)	03	01-UR; 01-OBC; 01-ST
F5	Dy. Project Officer (Design)	02	01-UR; 01-OBC
F6	Dy. Project Officer (HR)	02	01-UR; 01-SC
F7	Dy. Project Officer (Safety)	01	01-UR
F8	Dy. Project Officer (Fire Safety)	01	01-UR

The details are available in the HSL website (<https://www.hslvizag.in>) Click on “Careers” under “Human Resources” to view the openings available.
Advt. No. HR/ES(O)/0102/04/2026
Dated: 03 Jun 2026
General Manager (HR)

INBRIEF



Minister submits demands on road projects to Nitin Gadkari

Minister for Public Works and Sports Development Aadhav Arjuna called on Union Minister for Road Transport and Highways Nitin Gadkari in New Delhi on Tuesday and submitted a memorandum related to road infrastructure development in the State. The Minister sought the upgradation of around 1,500 km of four-lane highways into six-lanes, the widening of the Chengalpattu-Tindivanam (NH-32), the Neelambur-Madukkarai (NH-544) and the Panjappur-Jeeyapuram-Karur (NH-81) stretches. The demands also include the widening of the Karur-Coimbatore (NH-81) stretch, constructing elevated corridors on Madhavaram-Cholavaram (NH-16) and Maduravoyal-Sriperumbudur (NH-48) stretches.

Youth attacked after clash between two groups dies

A 25-year-old man, Vishnu, who was undergoing treatment following an altercation between two groups while playing cricket on May 24 on MPT playground in Tondiarpet, died on Monday. Police said the clash was between two groups, each led by members of the TVK, Manikandan and Naresh. On May 26 night, Vishnu, brother-in-law of Manikandan, was attacked in his shop by a gang allegedly led by Naresh. The New Washermenpet police have arrested six persons in the case. Further probe is on.

Metro Rail suffers a drop in ridership whenever students are on vacation

The drop over the past two months is attributed to the exam season and summer vacation, as school and college students make up nearly 30% of the total commuters using Chennai Metro Rail

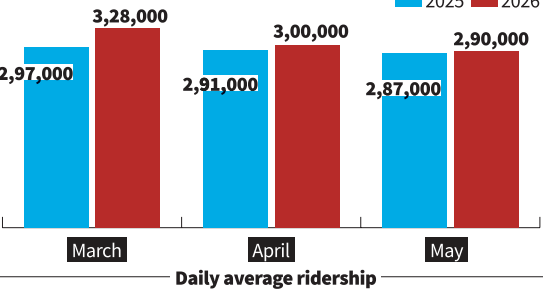
TRACK TALES

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Exam season and summer vacation have together created a drop in Chennai Metro Rail system's ridership over the last two months. During the months of April and May, Chennai Metro Rail saw a daily average of three lakh and 2.90 lakh people using the services respectively. The Metro Rail saw an average ridership of 3.28 lakh passengers every day in the month of March. According to officials of Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL), nearly 30% of the people who use the network comprise school and college students. "Hence, for these two months, April and May, when the final examinations are held and the institutions break for vacation, we see a reduction in the

A familiar pattern

Officials said it would be difficult to attract commuters to use Metro Rail without a robust last-mile connectivity



ridership. After June 15, the number of people travelling will significantly increase," an official said. Officials said, this is a pattern they see every year

when the trains carry lesser number of commuters during exam and holiday season. For instance, in April and May 2025, CMRL re-

corded an average daily ridership of 2.91 lakh and 2.87 lakh passengers as against 2.97 lakh in March 2025. In June, the ridership was 3.07 lakh. CMRL has a long-way to go to achieve its projected ridership of 7.75 lakh travellers a day.

Major challenge

"Unless we are able to create a robust last-mile connectivity system, wherein feeder vehicles such as buses and share auto-rickshaws get closer to the doorstep of commuters, it will be hard to draw a significant number of new commuters. We also expect a rise in the ridership when the first stretch of the phase II project from Poonamallee to Vadapalani is launched," he added. A decade has passed since the commencement of Chennai Metro Rail services, yet, a well-developed last mile connectivity system has not become a reality.



Dignitaries at the inaugural event of the 'Comprehensive Voice, Airway and Swallow Clinic' at Apollo Proton Cancer Centre on Tuesday. R. RAGU

Clinic launched for providing aftercare support to head and neck cancer survivors

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Apollo Proton Cancer Centre (APCC) on Tuesday launched a 'Comprehensive Voice, Airway and Swallow Clinic' (C-VASC) to provide aftercare support to persons who had undergone treatments for head and neck cancers, and are having difficulty speaking, swallowing, or breathing. A press release said the initiative sought to assist patients in recovering vital functions and enhancing their quality of life post-cancer treatment by merging technologies with rehabilitation support.

ing for laryngeal cancer. Naveen Hedne, senior consultant, head and neck, surgical oncology, APCC, said patients should overcome their fear and seek timely treatment for head and neck cancers. The focus is not only on cure but care beyond cure, he said.

Impaired functions Speech therapist Arathi Soman said breathing, speaking, and eating were basic functions for a human being. About 80% of patients with head and neck cancers have either one or multiple of these functions impaired. The symptoms include hoarseness of voice, strained voice, shortness of breath, chronic coughing, noisy breathing, pain while swallowing, and coughing during meals. The common cause in head and neck cancer patients is tumour location, surgery, radiotherapy, and chemotherapy, she said.

"Many walk away post treatment as warriors but have altered quality of life such as inhibitions eating in public spaces or speaking over the phone. The clinic aims to improve not only cancer survival but also provide the survivors a better quality of life," Dr. Soman said. The clinic will also offer professional voice care for singers, actors, dubbing artists, news anchors, attorneys, and radio jockeys. Sandip Duarah, senior consultant, head and neck, surgical oncology, was also present.

T.N. deserves to have world-class airports, says CII Chairman

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

"South India has some of the best airports in the country. We have world-class airports in Bengaluru and Hyderabad, and Tamil Nadu deserves to be in the top three and not in the top seven", said P. Ravichandran, Chairman, CII Southern Region and President of Danfoss India, during a press meet that was organised by the CII.

When asked about the Parandur airport project, he said: "We have not had any dialogue with the government on this topic. Whatever they decide, we need to respect the decision." To a query on how im-

portant the Parandur airport project is for Tamil Nadu from an industry's perspective, he said, "It is very important. Even getting efficiency on the first (airport) is important because where the investor lands is important. We deserve a bigger and better airport in Tamil Nadu."

GSDP growth

A delegation from CII recently met Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay. About CII's meeting with the Chief Minister, he said: "The TVK's manifesto talks about achieving a \$1.5 trillion economy by 2036. To achieve this, the GSDP of Tamil Nadu has to multiply by 3.5 to 3.8 times what it is today. This means a year-



Ravichandran, Chairman, CII Southern Region, addressing a press conference in Chennai on Tuesday. R. RAGU

on-year growth of about 12-13% for the next ten years. One of the key recommendations we made to the Chief Minister was to leverage his personal brand and attract more investments into the State, Mr. Ravi-

chandran added. He also pointed out that operational costs have gone up because of the war in West Asia. "The challenge for the manufacturing sector is that operating costs have increased. Fuel and raw

material prices have gone up, and freight charges have gone up almost 2.5 times," he added.

Noting that Tamil Nadu has a larger number of women across shop floors, Mr. Ravichandran said Tamil Nadu can target two million jobs by 2030 by supporting more women.

India's growth engine

According to the data shared by him, Southern India continues to be one of the strongest contributors to India's economic progress, accounting for nearly 32% of the country's GDP and around 30% of India's manufacturing GVA. He noted that the region has emerged as a major growth engine, with a com-

bined GDP of ₹57.16 lakh crore in FY25 at constant prices, and contributes nearly 40% of India's total services output.

Outlining the priorities for 2026-27, he said CII Southern Region will work around the theme "Accelerating South India's Competitiveness: Growth, Resilience, Inclusion, Sustainability, Trust." The focus areas for the year will include manufacturing and MSME growth, digital transformation and AI, green transition and energy security, talent excellence, agri-value chains and food processing, infrastructure and logistics, global markets and FTA leverage, and tourism and the sports economy.

GCC to begin immunising stray, pet dogs against rabies in August

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

In a bid to prevent rabies and control animal bite cases in the city, the Greater Chennai Corporation will start mass immunisation of stray dogs and pet dogs in August.

As many as 1.47 lakh animals, including stray dogs and pets, were immunised as part of the anti-rabies vaccination drive last year. This year the number is expected to increase to 1.7 lakh dogs. Residents have been asked to get their pets

immunised when GCC workers visit the neighbourhoods for mass immunisation of stray dogs.

According to data compiled in various hospitals in the city, the number of dog bite cases has been increasing for the past few months. In April, the dog bite cases increased to 4,390 when compared with 3,970 cases in March. In February, the number of dog bite cases was 3,479 while 3,381 persons received treatment in the hospitals in January.

Of the 14 major hospitals

where a large number of animal bite cases are registered in Chennai, Periyar Government Hospital in Periyar Nagar registered the highest number, with 844 cases in April.

The GCC has not been able to assess the impact of animal bite cases in the city as many of the private hospitals have not shared data on animal bite cases. Corporation officials said additional animal birth control centres at five new locations are expected to be launched in three months.

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
No. DYCEBRLINE-II-2026-01, Dated: 27/05/2026
For and behalf of the President of India, the Dy. Chief Engineer/Bridge Line-2/North Western Railway, Jaipur invites online open E-Tendering system (Single Packet) for the following works on prescribed electronics forms:-
1. E-Tender No.: DYCEBRLINE-II-2025-01
2. Name of the work with its location:- Strengthening of Substructure and Replacement of existing steel girders of 12.20m Span - Br.19 (Galwa) SWM-JP (7x12.20) by Post tensioned PSC Slabs, Lifting/Linking of Track, Supply of Ballast, Earthwork, Blanketing work and other ancillary work as per 25T loading standard in the jurisdiction of Dy.CE/Bridge Line - 11/J.P. 3. Approx. cost of work: Rs. 8,37,74,929.86
4. Earnest Money to be deposited: 16,75,500.00
5. Completion Period: 18 Month 6. Date & Time closing of tender: 19/06/2026 at 15.00 Hrs
7. Website particulars and notice board location where complete detail of tender can be seen: www.ireps.gov.in
806-CQ/26
Follow us on: f t i c /NWRRailways NWRRailways

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
Replacement of MCI OHE CLA fittings with forged OHE CLA fitting in DDU Division
Open e-tender notice no. TRD/OT/05/MCI/CLA/26-27
E-tenders are invited from reputed contractors having proven experience, electrical license and sound financial standing supported by the valid documents for the work as per details given below.
Sl.No.: 1. Name of work with location:- Replacement of MCI OHE CLA fitting with forged OHE CLA fittings in DDU Division.
2. Approx. Cost of the work: Rs. 92,29,442.04
3. Earnest Money/Bid Security to be deposited: Rs. 18,46,000.00
4. Last date and time for submission of tender: 22/06/2026 at 15:00 hrs.
5. Website particulars from where the details of e-tender can be obtained: www.ireps.gov.in
Sr. Divnl. Elect. Engineer (TRD)
East Central Railway/DDU
PR/0341/DDU/ELECT/7/26-27/28

ODISHA CONSTRUCTION CORPORATION LTD.
(A Govt. of Odisha Undertaking)
CENTRAL WORKSHOP, RASULGARH,
Bhubaneswar-751010 (Odisha)
Tel- 0674 : 2580107, E-mail: gmocclwsg@gmail.com
(GSTIN-21AAACO2571K22M)
"e" - Procurement Notice No. 05 /OCCL/2026-27 (on-line)
Type of work : Supply of cast iron billet plate for 35T gantry crane of Telengiri Irrigation Project.
Total No. of work : 01 (One).
Period of supply : 90 (Ninety) days.
Procurement Officer : Bid Identification No. : Cost of Tender document (Including GST) through on-line transfer system : Availability of Tender (On-line) : Submission of Bid (On-line) :
General Manager (Mech.), OCC Ltd., Central Workshop, Rasulgarh, Bhubaneswar : OCCL-MECH/ CWS/ 03/2026-27 : Rs.11,800/- (Non-refundable) : 03.06.2026 10.00 AM to 22.06.2026 5.00 PM : 03.06.2026 10.00 AM to 22.06.2026 5.00 PM
Date of opening of the Technical Bid: 23.06.2026 at 11.30 A.M.
Further details can be seen from the Govt. website (www.tendersodisha.gov.in)
Amendment/corrigendum/cancellation, if any shall be posted on-line only.
Sd/- General Manager (Mech.), OCC Ltd., Bhubaneswar
34001/293/2627 OIPR-34001/34163/1/26-27/0007

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

Mr. BANSILAL KESHAVJI SHAH (86), Father of Mr. Jitendra Shah, Chennai-600017, expired on 02-06-2026. Eyes donated to Rotary Rajan Eye Bank (Project of Rotary Club of Madras T.Nagar), Chennai- 17 (Ph: 28340500).

SAD DEMISE

With profound grief, we inform the sad demise of **SRI. V. GOPALAN (86)** who passed away on 02/06/2026. He leaves behind his beloved wife **Sumitha Gopalan**, Daughter **Yeswini Harish** and son-in-law **Harish N**. May his soul attain Sadgati and rest in eternal peace. Residence: Flat no. 6, No. 3 Ananda Road, Alwarpet, Chennai 600018. Contact: 8444495248

REMEMBRANCE

2nd Death Anniversary
N N Neelakantan
15.8.1937 - 3.6.2024
We deeply miss you every day.
Saraswathy, Shailaja, Latika, Anagha

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

20th ANNIVERSARY
P. NARAYANAN ALIAS MANI
Respectable Homage to our beloved Founder Trustee of JRS Global Senior Secondary School, Kattankulathur
JRS Matric Hr Sec School, Kattankulathur
Janaki Ramachandran Matric School, Ch-26
Thai Sathya Matric School, Ch- 93
MGR Primary School, Ch- 26
MGR Hr Sec School, Ch- 24
Your's Ramachandran N The Trustee & Correspondent

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

20th ANNIVERSARY
Mrs. LAKSHMI W/o.Late D.Rangaswamy Fondly Remembered by Mrs. & Mr. R.Sundar & Sons' Family

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES
To dedicate a space in this section, Please contact: 044-28576300 from 10.00 a.m. to 6.00 p.m.
Toll Free: 1800 102 4161 from 10.00 a.m. to 10.00 p.m.
For Placing Advertisements Online log on to www.thehinduads.com
DONATE EYES - GIFT SIGHT

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
E-TENDER NOTICE NO.:-
SG-DSE-OT-12-26
S.N. : 1. Name of work with its location :
Provision of MSDAC in parallel to DC track circuit at newly commissioned ANH & NBS station of DDU Division. **2. Approx. Cost of the work :** ₹6,52,81,894.61/- (Six Crore Fifty Two Lakh Eighty One Thousand Eight Hundred Ninety Four and Paise Sixty One only). **3. Earnest Money :** ₹13,05,600.00/- (Thirteen Lakh Five Thousand Six Hundred only.). **4. Closing date & time for submission of e-tendering :** 22/06/2026 up to 12:30 Hrs. **5. Website particulars where complete details of tender can be seen etc.:** www.ireps.gov.in
Divnl. Signal & Telecom Engineer
East Central Railway, DDU
PR/0334/DDU/S&T/T/26-27/24

RAIL WHEEL FACTORY
Yelahanka, BANGALORE - 560 064
Website: www.rwf.indianrailways.gov.in
Tender Notice No. RWFPCCEELTD 2026-27/02 Dated 15.05.2026
E-Tender: On behalf of the President of India, the Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer invite electronic tender for the following work online through the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> (Works).
Tender No.: RWFPCCEELTD2026-27/02
Dtd: 15.05.2026. **Name of the Work:** Development of online monitoring and control of electrical assets with INTRANET at RWF. **Estimated Cost:** Rs. 45,52,334/- **EMD:** Rs. 91,100/- **Date of Closing of Tenders:** 15.06.2026 at 11:00 Hrs.
Tender Notice No. RWF/PCEE/EL/TD/2026-27/03 Dated 27.05.2026
Tender No.: RWFPCCEELTD2026-27/03
Dtd: 27.05.2026. **Name of the Work:** Electrical improvement works in West and East Colony at RWF using Solar Energy installations. **Estimated Cost:** Rs. 2,17,29,071/- **EMD:** Rs. 4,34,600/- **Date of Closing of Tenders:** 18.06.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.
The above Tender details can be viewed on our website www.rwf.indianrailways.gov.in
Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
No. DNR/S&T/Sig/2026/8 Danapur, Dtd. 29.05.2026
Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecom), East Central Railway, Danapur Division, for and on behalf of President of India invites tenders on web portal www.ireps.gov.in for the following work:-
1. Name of work with its location : Strengthening and Augmentation of Signalling Assets at LC gates for reliability improvement, enhancing safety and improving punctuality in Train operations along with alteration in EI for the closure of LC gates at various interlocked LC gates under Danapur division. **2. Approx cost of work:** Rs. 65323069.55, **3. Earnest Money :** Rs. 1306500.00. **4. Last Date & Time of submission :** Up to 15:00 hrs. on 22.06.2026. **5. Opening of tender:** 15:00 hrs. on 22.06.2026. **6. Website particulars where details of the work and criteria can be seen :** www.ireps.gov.in. **7. Address of the office from where detail information can be obtained :** Sr. Divnl. Signal & Telecommunication Engineer, East Central Railway, Danapur.
Note : Any corrigendum if required will be uploaded on above website before 14 days.
Asst. Signal & Telecom Engineer
East Central Railway, Danapur
PR/0339/DNR/S&T/T/26-27/36

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY
Open E-Tender Notice, Date: 01.06.2026
Sr. DEN/CO/WCR, Bhopal acting for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-Tenders against following works, upto 15:30 hours on the dates mentioned against each tender. The complete tender documents and detail information regarding tender, is available on the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. NIT can also be seen on the notice board of DRM (W)/WCR/ Bhopal office. Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders. For any correction, in these tenders, if necessary, corrigendum will be uploaded on website prior to tender opening date and copy of corrigendum will be placed on Notice Board of this office, which may be seen upto the date of tender opening. Tenderers are requested to offer their rates and submit tenders according to the provisions of GST ACT 2017. **NIT No. WCR-BPL-W :- 26-27-S-04-29, Date : 19.05.2026, Name of work including Location :-** Itarsi Supply of drinking water (Potable) in required quantity, as and when and where required in Itarsi Railway station, Passenger yard and New Yard Colonies for Two year under ADEN (W) ET., **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 13951250.00, **Earnest Money : 279000, Completion period : 24 Months, Last date for submitting tender : 11-06-2026, NIT No. WCR-BPL-W :- 26-27-HQ-07-30, Date : 20-05-2026, Name of work including Location :** Bhopal Division Construction of New EI Building at Rani Kamalapati Station in connection with Provision of distributed EI in lieu of existing RRI along with provision of MSDAC in parallel with DC track circuits at Rani Kamalapati ADEN(Works) Bhopal., **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 44973611.12, **Earnest Money : 899500, Completion period : 8 Months, Last date for submitting tender : 12.06.2026, NIT No. WCR-BPL-W :- 26-27-W-05-31, Date : 20.05.2026, Name of work including Location :-** Itarsi Supply of drinking water (Potable) for two year at various Railway station, colonies, gang quarters & gang huts as and when required., **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 2492735.00, **Earnest Money : 49900, Completion period : 24 Months, Last date for submitting tender : 11.06.2026, NIT No. WCR-BPL-W :- 26-27-W-05-32, Date : 21.05.2026, Name of work including Location :** Execution & supply of AT welding portions of 60 KG 90-UTS/R-260 Rails with Single Shot Crucible under Sr.DEN/W/Bhopal., **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 10216248.15, **Earnest Money : 204300, Completion period : 18 Months, Last date for submitting tender : 12.06.2026, NIT No. WCR-BPL-W :- 26-27-W-06-33, Date : 21.05.2026, Name of work including Location :** Rithuiyal-Maksi section: Construction of New station building in lieu of old station building at Khumbhara and Chachogra Bhinaganj stations., **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 45565544.44, **Earnest Money : 911300, Completion period : 12 Months, Last date for submitting tender : 12.06.2026, NIT No. WCR-BPL-W :- 26-27-G-04-34, Date : 22-05-2026, Name of work including Location :** Execution & Supply of AT Welding portions of 60 KG 90-UTS/R-260 Rails with Single Shot Crucible under Sr.DEN/C/Bhopal., **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 17416410.77, **Earnest Money : 348300, Completion period : 18 Months, Last date for submitting tender : 12.06.2026, NIT No. WCR-BPL-W :- 26-27-W-07-35, Date : 26-05-2026, Name of work including Location :** Interlocking of LC gate no. 146, 131 and 136 along with associated signalling and telecom work in Rithuiyal-Maksi section over Bhopal division., **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 18202016.63, **Earnest Money : 364100, Completion period : 6 Months, Last date for submitting tender : 17.06.2026, NIT No. WCR-BPL-W :- 26-27-N-15-36, Date : 28-05-2026, Name of work including Location :** Bhopal Division - Bina & Guna - Improvement of colony roads for Jurisdiction of Sr.DEN(North) Bhopal., **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 18722100.45, **Earnest Money : 374500, Completion period : 6 Months, Last date for submitting tender : 19.06.2026, NIT No. WCR-BPL-W :- 26-27-N-16-37, Date : 28-05-2026, Name of work including Location :** Part (A) Execution of Turnout Sleeper Renewal (TTR(TSR)-21 sets), and Renewal of Turnouts (TTR(TFS+TWR+CMS)05 sets) under the DEN/N/BPL section. Part-(B) Execution of TTR(P), TFR, De-stressing work, and other track-related works in ADEN/BINA & ADEN/GUNA section under the jurisdiction of DEN/N/BPL section. Part-(C) BPL-BINA & BINA-MDVK Section-Provision of asphaltting and repaving of existing Road surface at level crossings, etc and other ancillary works at Level Crossing No-003, 297, 300, 301, 302 and 305 under ADEN BINA. (TRACK WORK), **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 28706575.51, **Earnest Money : 574100, Completion period : 12 Months, Last date for submitting tender : 19.06.2026, NIT No. WCR-BPL-W :- 26-27-HQ-08-38, Date : 01-06-2026, Name of work including Location :** Part-(A), Bhopal - Provision of new 12 Nos Type-II Quarters in lieu of Type-I Quarters of Nishatpura (G+2) including Electrical work under ADEN(Works) Bhopal. Part-(B), Extension of CBT Centre Bhopal Division at MDDTI Bhopal (Area Training Centre, Bhopal) under ADEN(Works) Bhopal., **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 27563488.53, **Earnest Money : 551300, Completion period : 12 Months, Last date for submitting tender : 23.06.2026, NIT No. WCR-BPL-W :- 26-27-HQ-09-39, Date : 01.06.2026, Name of work including Location :** FRP Grating to cover drainage at Pass Yard Bhopal, Bina and Guna Station, **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 22363869.07, **Earnest Money : 447300, Completion period : 9 Months, Last date for submitting tender : 23.06.2026, NIT No. WCR-BPL-W :- 26-27-C-05-40, Date : 01.06.2026, Name of work including Location :** Raising of existing platforms to High Level at Obaidullaganj (1), Misrod (3), Sukhi Sewania (2), Dewanganj (2), Salamapur (2), Sumar (2), Gulabganj (1) and Pabai (2) stations in Itarsi-Bina section under Sr.DEN/C/Bhopal jurisdiction, **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 267804145.43, **Earnest Money : 5356100, Completion period : 18 Months, Last date for submitting tender : 23.06.2026**
DRM (W), West Central Railway, Bhopal



स्वच्छ भारत अभियान एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

FACT दि फर्टिलाइज़र्स एण्ड केमिकल्स ट्रावन्कोर लिमिटेड
PIONEERS IN PROGRESS THE FERTILISERS AND CHEMICALS TRAVANCORE LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise) Regd. Office: Floor, Projects and Planning, PO Administration Building, Udyogamandal, Kochi, Kerala, India. : 693 5011, TEL: 91 484 256 8289/ 91 484 254 8662
Email: bblid@factindia.com; avinash.c@factindia.com; http://www.fact.co.in
NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST
GLOBAL TENDER FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST REGARDING ENGAGING CONSULTANT TO CONDUCT A DETAILED TECHNO ECONOMIC FEASIBILITY STUDY ON TECHNOLOGY UPGRADE/ADATION AND FORWARD INTEGRATION OF CARPOLACTAM PLANT.
EOI Reference no: 5071/2026-2027/E33617. Due date: 23.06.2026 14:00:00hrs. IST
For detailed tender documents please visit website eprocure.gov.in. For any clarifications please contact Deputy General Manager (Projects and Planning), Projects and Planning Department, FACT Udyogamandal Complex, Pincode-683501

HEMWATI NANDAN BAHUGUNA UTTARAKHAND MEDICAL EDUCATION UNIVERSITY
NEW CENTRAL HOPETOWN, BAYAKHALA, SELAQUI, DEHRADUN-248011
WEBSITE: www.hnbmu.ac.in, E-mail-info.hnbmu@gmail.com
Ref. No. 482 /HNBUMU/2026-27 Date: 02.06.2026
Advertisement for the Post of Registrar HNBUMU
Applications are invited from interested, eligible, Indian Citizens for the one post of Registrar through direct recruitment/deputation **as per government order number 382933/XXVIII(V)/2026(E-26031)**. The post carries the pay scale 66700-206700 with (level-11)
Applicants may visit our Website: www.hnbmu.ac.in for detailed advertisement including eligibility, general instructions, application form and all other updates about this advertisement. The last date for submission of application by speed post and the same by email also is **01 July 2026**. The candidate must download the application form from university website and attach copies of all relevant testimonials, documents duly self-attested and submit the same with filled complete form to the **"Vice Chancellor, Hemwati Nandan Bahuguna Uttarakhand Medical Education University Bayakhala, New central hope town selaqu, Dehradun-248011, Uttarakhand (India)"**, so as to reach her, on or before **01 July 2026** by speed Post and the same set as PDF copy in email (vchnbmu2@gmail.com) only. Applications received both by speed post and the same PDF copy in email on or before **01/07/2026** will be considered for recruitment process. **VICE CHANCELLOR HNBUMU, DEHRADUN**

Uttar Pradesh Medical Supplies Corporation Limited
(CIN: U85310UP2018SGC102425) (A Government of Uttar Pradesh Undertaking)
Address: SUDA Bhawan, 7/23, Sector-7, Gomati Nagar Extension, Lucknow
Advertisement No:- UPMSC/L04/HR/2026-27/227 Dated: 01/06/2026
Uttar Pradesh Medical Supplies Corporation Limited invites application for the following positions on Deputation/ Contractual:

Sr. No.	Designation	Maximum Age (in Year)	Vacancy	Category	Mode of Recruitment	Honoraria in INR (Monthly)	Essential Qualification	Desirable Qualification	Post Qualification experience
1	General Manager (AHL)	45	01	UR	Deputation/ Contractual	(78,800-1,40,000) Pay Level - 12 (in case of Deputation)	Applicant must have MBA degree in Human Resources from recognized Institution/University	Degree in Law from recognized Institution/ University	Applicant must have minimum 8 year's Overall experience with at least 3 years of supervisory experience
2	Manager (Legal)	45	01	UR	Deputation/ Contractual	(56,100-80,000) Pay Level-10 (in case of Deputation)	Applicant must have Bachelor Degree in Law (LLB) from UGC recognized Indian University	Applicant have master degree in law (LLM) from UGC recognized Indian University	Applicant must have 5 year's work experience as a full time Manager Legal in any Company (Govt. Private)
3	Pharmacist (Drug Procurement)	45	01	SC	Deputation/ Contractual	(47,600-50,000) Pay Matrix -8 (in case of Deputation)	Applicant must have full time B.Pharm degree or graduate in Science (Chemistry/Bio-Chemistry) discipline from a recognized University/Institution	M.Pharm degree will be preferred	Applicant must have 01 year overall experience, of which at least six months experience must be in drug procurement drug logistics or drug supply chain

* Interested Candidates must send their application form in the prescribed format along with self attested relevant document by speed post/registered AD from Indian Postal Department by mentioning on the envelop "Application for the (Post Name) to I/C GM (AHL), SUDA Bhawan 7/23 sector -7 Gomi nagar extension, Lucknow PIN-226002. Applications sent by any other mode shall not be entertained. Submission of Application Starts from June 02, 2026. * The Last Date of Submission of Application is July 01, 2026 at 06:00 PM. * Regular government (Department/Corporations/Institutions) employees with suitable experience on seniority (matrix level) are encouraged to apply on deputation. * Vacancies shall be subject to the State reservation policy of Uttar Pradesh. * Age relaxation shall be provided as per the State reservation policy. Candidate applying on Deputation shall be in accordance with Govt. of UP Service Norms. * Please note that last date of application form shall be taken as a reference date for computing age, qualification, experience etc. Application not received on prescribed format will be rejected. Application format may be download from the website- www.upmsc.in
For vacancy notification and other related detailed information please visit www.upmsc.in

Department of Medical Health & Family Welfare, Uttar Pradesh

CENTRAL RAILWAY
WAGON REPAIR WORKSHOP
Open tender notice no:-
BD.WRB.41.Welding-26-27-A
Date:- 23.05.2026
Sr. No. 1. Name of Work : BODY POH work of 1050 Wagons (BOXN variant and SS wagons) for a period of one year at Wagon Repair Workshop, Badnera.
Approx Cost. : ₹ 14,40,26,752.89/-
Cost of tender form (Rs.) : NIL, **EMD (Rs): ₹ 8,70,100/-**, **Completion Period :** 12 months. The time and date for submission of above e-tenders will be up to 15.00 hrs on 15.06.2026. Complete details of e-tender are available at official Railway website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> DE/224
TRAVEL SAFELY, AVOID FOOTBOARD TRAVELLING

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
Chennai Division (Works Branch)
E-Tender Notice No.17/2026 DATED: 30.05.2026

S.No	Item No	Description
1.	MAS17OF26073W	Provision of facilities for Divyangjan at 10 Number of Stations in AJJ-CGL Section. CJ (NSG 4), TMLP, WJ, PALR (NSG 6), TKO, NTT, PYV, VB, RDY (HG 3), CJE (HG 1).
2.	MAS17OF26074W	Provision of facilities for Divyangjan at 8 Number of Stations in ADEN/KPD Subdivision. WJR & SHU (NSG 5), POI, NG, VGA, TDK & PUDI (NSG 6), VKZ (HG3).
3.	MAS17OF26075W	Provision of facilities for Divyangjan at 11 Number of Stations in ADEN/JTTJ Subdivision. AB, VN, GYM (NSG 5), KVN, LTI, SVUR, THL, TUG, LTRE & MCN (NSG 6), AVN (HG 1), & VJ (HG3).
4.	MAS17OF26076W	Provision of facilities for Divyangjan at 9 Number of Stations in ADEN/JTTJ Subdivision. AB, VN, GYM (NSG 5), KDY, VGM, PCKM, MPI & VLT (NSG 6), MEH (HG 3).
5.	MAS17OF26077E	Provision of Tactile flooring at stations and FOBs in MAS - GDR section to facilitate Divyangjan passenger under Sugamya Bharat Campaign.

Date and Time of Tender Opening:- 22.06.2026 @ 11.30 Hours
Complete details & Tender Document will be available at <http://www.ireps.gov.in>
Divisional Railway Manager/Works/Chennai-03

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Tender Notice- 11PR/NCR/Social Media/2026 Date: 01.06.2026
E-Tender Notice
The Chief Public Relations Officer, North Central Railway for and on behalf of President of India invites Applications from the interested agencies from the open market on prescribed Application Form for the following
Full Name of Service/Work: SELECTION OF AGENCY FOR SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT AND MEDIA ANALYSIS SERVICES FOR NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY (FOR TWO YEARS)
Appx. Total Cost of Service/Work (Exclusive of GST): Rs. 3,95,00,000.00/- Exclusive of GST (Rs. Three Crore Ninety Five Lakh Only) per annum; or Rs. 7,90,00,000.00/- Exclusive of GST (Rs. Seven Crore Ninety Lakh only) for two years
Appx Total Cost of Service/Work (with GST 18%): Rs.4,66,10,000.00/- (Rs. Four Crore Sixty Six Lakh Ten Thousand and Only) per annum; or Rs. 9,32,20,000.00/- with 18%GST (Rs. Nine Crore Thirty Two Lakh Twenty Thousand Only) for two years.
Earnest Money Amount: Rs. 6,16,100/- (Rs. Six Lakh Sixteen Thousand One Hundred Only)
Cost of Application Form: Rs. 10,000/- + 18% GST = Rs.11,800/- (Non-Refundable) (Rs. Eleven Thousand Eight Hundred only) in cash across the Railway Counter or if downloaded from website - Demand Draft/Pay Order in favour of FA&CAO, North Central Railway, Prayagraj, (In case if Application Form is required by Post - Rs. 500/- will be charged extra)
Last Date of downloading Application Form from NCR's official Website/ Purchase from Public Relations Department NCR, Prayagraj: Up to 12.00 hrs. on 24.06.2026
Last Date/Time of submission of Application: Up to 12.30 hrs. on 24.06.2026
Date & Time of Opening of Applications: On 24.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs. onwards
Venue for Application Submission and Application opening: CPRO Office, Old GM Building, Near Balmiki Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj-211001
Particulars of the Website from where the Application Form and Tender Notice may be downloaded: www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in
Note:- 1. Cost of Application form and Earnest money shall be deposited with FA&CAO North Central Railway either through Bank draft/FDR drawn on scheduled banks or in cash and original money receipt attached with application. 2. In case the Application opening date is declared a holiday, the Application can be submitted and opened the next day at the same time as fixed earlier. 3. Complete Eligibility Criteria and other details are available in the tender document. 1236/26 (D)
North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in cp@ncroncr

BUSINESS CONNECT**GRT Hostel Empowers Students**

Reaffirming its commitment to education and social welfare, GRT Jewellers continues to support deserving students through the GRT Mahalakshmi Boys Hostel in Porur, Chennai. Designed for economically disadvantaged students

across Tamil Nadu pursuing higher education in the city, the hostel offers free accommodation, nutritious meals and scholarships for meritorious candidates. Facilities include yoga, Spoken English classes, library access and indoor games to support overall development. Speaking about the initiative, Mr. G.R. 'Anand' Ananthapadmanabhan, Managing Director, GRT Jewellers, added, "At GRT Jewellers, we strongly believe that meaningful social progress begins with education. Mr. G.R. Radhakrishnan, Managing Director, GRT Jewellers, said, "Education plays an important role in shaping a better future for individuals and society. Students completing Class XII this year are eligible to apply, with preference given to those from single-parent families.

Hatsun Chess at the Commonwealth

Young players from Hatsun Chess Academy delivered an impressive performance at the Commonwealth Chess Championship 2026 in Sri Lanka, securing 13 medals across Rapid, Classical and Blitz

categories. Leading the charge were Tamizh Amudhan S. and Meha Arin A., who clinched gold medals in the Rapid segment in the Under-10 Boys and Under-12 Girls categories respectively. Nandish VS, Marium Fatima and Kritan Boggarapu added to the tally with podium finishes. The academy continued its strong run in the Classical and Blitz events. Hatsun Sports Academy credited disciplined training and expert coaching for the international success.

Poorvika Unveils LG Electronics

LG Electronics India has recently expanded its home entertainment portfolio with the launch of its 2026 premium OLED and QNED television range at the Poorvika showroom in Porur, Chennai. The new lineup, unveiled in the presence of Poorvika CEO Uvaraj Natarajan and LG Chennai Branch Manager Mohamed Ashiq, will be available across over 48 Poorvika outlets in Tamil Nadu on a later date. The OLED Evo C6 and G6 series feature AI-powered picture quality, Dolby Vision and Atmos, gaming support up to 165Hz VRR, and smart integrations including Google Gemini and Microsoft Copilot. The QNED Evo Mini LED range offers enhanced contrast, gaming features and AI-powered smart experiences.

A Business Initiative**Sachin Kurve at Chennai Port**

Sachin Sharadchandra Kurve has assumed charge as Chairperson of the Chennai Port Authority, succeeding Sunil Palliwal, now Chairman of the Inland Waterways Authority of India. A 2003-batch IAS officer of the Uttarakhand cadre and a Mechanical Engineering graduate from Visvesvaraya National Institute of Technology, Kurve brings over two decades of administrative experience across tourism, civil aviation, rural development, health and governance. Having held senior roles in Uttarakhand and Maharashtra, he is known for citizen-centric administration, institutional reforms and infrastructure-led development. At Chennai Port, he is expected to focus on modernization, digital transformation and sustainable maritime operations.

Navin's Hosts Summer Glow Party

Navin's, a leading Chennai-based real estate developer, hosted a vibrant summer glow party for children at Navin's Starwood Towers 3.0 in Medavakkam, bringing together over

100 families for an evening of fun and community bonding. Organised for children aged 6 to 13, the poolside celebration aimed to encourage outdoor engagement during the summer holidays and offer a break from gadgets. The event featured glow-themed activities, DJ music, mocktails, snacks and interactive games designed to keep children entertained. Beyond the festivities, the gathering strengthened connections among residents and reflected Navin's focus on fostering a lively, family-oriented neighbourhood culture. At Navin's Starwood Towers 3.0, such celebrations continue to play an important role in fostering a vibrant neighbourhood culture, creating opportunities for families to connect and enjoy a stronger sense of belonging.

Lalitha Jewellery Opens in Porur

Lalitha Jewellery has recently inaugurated its new showroom in Porur, Chennai, expanding its presence in South India after over four decades in the jewellery business. Located on Arcot Road near the Porur

Metro, the showroom features an extensive collection of gold, diamond jewellery and silverware, blending traditional and contemporary designs. As part of the launch offer, customers can avail reduced value addition charges on gold jewellery. Dr M. Kiran Kumar, Chairman, says "As an entrepreneur who understands the value of hard earned money, I deeply empathize with my customers. This is why I focus on educating them about the art and science of buying jewellery." Known for its emphasis on trust and transparency, Lalitha encourages price comparisons and provides detailed estimates. The showroom also introduces customer-centric schemes, including flexible jewellery savings plans and pre-booking options with zero value addition charges.

இந்து தமிழ் தின்து

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Tamil Nadu

INBRIEF



Senior Congress leader
Chidambaram meets CM

Senior Congress leader and former Union Finance Minister P. Chidambaram met Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at the Secretariat on Tuesday. This was the first time Mr. Chidambaram met Mr. Vijay since he assumed office as Chief Minister. Mr. Chidambaram was instrumental in the seat-sharing talks between the DMK and the Congress in the run-up to the 2026 election. Lieutenant-General V. Sreehari, General Officer Commanding, Dakshin Bharat Area, Indian Army; Sanjay Jayavarthanavelu, chairman and managing director of LMW Limited; and office-bearers of the Tamil Nadu Omni Bus Owners' Association also called on the Chief Minister. In a separate development, Assembly Secretary K. Srinivasan resigned from his post. Mr. Srinivasan had six months of service left. Speaking to *The Hindu*, he said he had resigned owing to personal reasons.

Two nodal officers posted to
implement Project STAR 3.0

The Registration Department has appointed two officials as nodal officers to ensure effective coordination, monitoring, implementation, and timely execution of activities related to Project STAR 3.0. The Department is in the process of migrating to STAR 3.0 – an upgraded version of its software system – from STAR 2.0 to ease the document registration process and provide next-generation computerised services using the latest technology. According to an official order issued by Inspector-General of Registration G.K. Arun Sundar Thalayan, as the contract period for Project STAR 2.0 has been completed, it has been decided to launch Project STAR 3.0 with innovative technological enhancements to improve service delivery, efficiency and digital transformation in the Registration Department. P. Kannan, Assistant Inspector-General of Registration (Vigilance), and E. Bhavani, District Registrar (Guideline), have been appointed as the nodal officers.

Govt. prepared for southwest
monsoon, says Sengottaiyan

Minister for Revenue and Disaster Management K.A. Sengottaiyan on Tuesday said the State government had taken all precautionary measures for the southwest monsoon. Speaking to journalists in Chennai, he said that as the southwest monsoon had commenced, the government was continuously monitoring the situation through radar systems at three locations. Officials had been conducting inspections in various districts, he added. “The Revenue and Disaster Management Department is functioning round the clock, and preparations are in full swing. Various agencies and volunteers are on standby to ensure a swift response and carry out relief operations. Steps have also been taken to seek assistance from the Centre,” he said. Mr. Sengottaiyan said he held discussions with the Electricity Minister on possible power outages during the rain, and the measures required to prevent disruption to power supply.

4 of a family
killed as car,
lorry collide

The Hindu Bureau
TIRUCHI

Four of a family were killed and three others injured in a road accident involving a car and a lorry at Jambunathapuram on Tuesday. A group of seven persons was travelling in the car from Kodumudi to Perambalur when the accident occurred. Police sources said the car hit the lorry, which was approaching from the opposite direction. Two persons travelling in the car – S. Balasubramanian, 31, and M. Karthik, 33 – were killed on the spot. Five injured persons were admitted to Musiri Government Hospital and later referred to Mahatma Gandhi Memorial Government Hospital in Tiruchi. Two of them – Kavitha, 27, and Murugesan, 50 – died of their injuries.

Chief Minister Vijay failing to uphold
constitutional morality, says A. Raja

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK deputy general secretary A. Raja on Tuesday accused Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay of failing to uphold constitutional morality and accountability while addressing a meeting in Tiruchi a day earlier to thank the voters. “It is unbecoming of a Chief Minister. If one compares the tone and tenor of his speech in the Assembly with the tone of ridicule and aggression in Tiruchi, one can sense tiredness, hesitation, and helplessness in his Assembly speech. Why did he deliver such a speech of bravado in Tiruchi? Who scripted it? If you compare the two speeches, you can understand the political manoeuvring, lamentation, and embarrassment behind it,” Mr. Raja told re-



A. Raja

porters at Anna Arivalayam, the DMK headquarters, in Chennai. Reacting to Mr. Vijay's assertion that the political contest was between the DMK and the TVK, and his use of the colloquial Tamil term, *Allu Chillu*, to describe parties other than the DMK, Mr. Raja wondered whether the Chief Minister was not embarrassed by such remarks. “You visited those *Allu Chillus*, presented them

with shawls, and sought their votes (during the trust vote). Was that decent politics or fraudulent politics? Do people not know about it? Can you say whatever pleases you,” Mr. Raja asked. **Politics of glamour** He said it was unfair on the part of the Chief Minister to react angrily to his comments about those who had urged the people to free themselves from the politics of glamour. “You are occupying a constitutional office, brother Vijay. We, too, have the right to question you,” he said. Mr. Raja said that while Mr. Vijay had every right to criticise the DMK, he should have spent some time explaining what transpired at his meeting with the Prime Minister, and what he had sought from

the Union government. “Do you know who [former Chief Minister] Stalin is? He once said he would not allow any violation of the Constitution in Tamil Nadu. Yet, you have merely issued an order seeking the invocation of constitutional provisions. A government can be dismissed if it violates the Constitution. We have not violated it. Yet, you are petitioning the Union government for intervention,” he said. Mr. Raja said the DMK could wait six months before offering a broader assessment of Mr. Vijay's government, but that did not mean it would refrain from commenting on day-to-day governance. “We will continue to speak about the administration. We will not remain silent simply because you ask us to,” he said.

220 MLAs bagged
less than 50% of
the votes polled

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

At least 220 candidates, who won in the 2026 Tamil Nadu Assembly election, secured less than 50% of the total votes polled in their constituencies, according to a report released on Tuesday by the Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR) and the Tamil Nadu Election Watch (TNEW). The report, which analysed the vote share and the margin of victory, said the winners won with an average of 38.99% of the total votes polled. In 2021, the winners won with an average of 48.37%, it added. Fourteen victorious candidates secured either 50% or more than 50% of the total votes polled in

‘Vijay sought meeting
with EPS, but AIADMK
didn’t grant him time’

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Minister for Energy Resources and Law R. Nirmalkumar on Tuesday claimed that Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay had sought an appointment with AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami after assuming office, but the AIADMK did not grant him the time. “Considering the political situation at the time, as the AIADMK had faced electoral setbacks, some leaders of the party felt that the meeting would not be appropriate. The appointment sought by the Chief Minister was not confirmed by the AIADMK,” the Minister said during an interaction with journalists at the Secretariat. Mr. Nirmalkumar's comments came in response to CPI(M) State secretary P. Shanmugam's statement that Mr. Vijay should have met Mr. Palaniswami, as he had met other political leaders after assuming office. He also defended the State government's position with respect to law and order. He said the Police Department had been taking immediate action

whenever crimes were reported, and the accused were being arrested promptly. “But under the previous government, the approach was lackadaisical. Action was taken by the government only after the intervention of the courts in some cases,” he said. “In some cases, murders are committed due to personal motives. But what matters is the action taken by the government after the incident,” he said. The Minister said strict measures had been taken against quarries operating illegally. **Farmers' protest** To a question on farmers protesting against the State government and demanding a full waiver of crop loans, Mr. Nirmalkumar said more than 12 lakh small and marginal farmers, who had taken loans from cooperative societies, had benefited from the crop loan waiver announced under various slabs. He claimed that some sections had protested on being instigated by the DMK. He said the Chief Minister would hold public meetings and continue to meet the people regularly.

Centre, T.N. govt. sign
MoU for Jal Jeevan
Mission 2.0 extension

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) between the Centre and Tamil Nadu was signed on Tuesday for the extended implementation of Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2.0 in the State. Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay participated in the virtual meeting from the Secretariat in Chennai, while Union Minister for Jal Shakti C.R. Patil took part from New Delhi. The MoU for JJM, which provides functional household tap connections, was signed following the Union Cabinet's approval to extend the scheme till December 2028.

First phase

Under the first phase of the scheme, 46.71 lakh household tap connections were

provided in the State, benefiting 1.86 crore people. Further, 45 new Multi Village Schemes (MVS), retrofitting works in 56 Combined Water Supply Schemes (CWSS), and 21,258 Single Village Schemes (SVS) were being implemented, according to an official release. Under the first phase of JJM, the approved outlay for the projects was ₹18,123.05 crore, of which the Union government's share was ₹9,025.68 crore and the Tamil Nadu government's share was ₹9,097.37 crore, the release added. With the signing of the MoU for the extended implementation of JJM 2.0, Tamil Nadu will initially receive ₹2,177.27 crore from the Centre's Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation (DDWS).

Should people die till CM finishes
crash course on governance: EPS

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Tuesday criticised the law and order situation in Tamil Nadu under the TVK-led government, and urged Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay to “step out of illusion, assume responsibility”, and uphold the rule of law. Criticising the government over the murder of a youth at Tondiarpet in Chennai, who had reportedly objected to the sale of ganja, Mr. Palaniswami said, “Is this the answer if someone challenges the sale of ganja? Is this the change?” Against this backdrop, Mr. Vijay, at a public meeting in Tiruchi on Monday, was concerned about the criticism against him, Mr. Palaniswami said. “He has apparently posted officers. Is that enough? Aren't



Edappadi K. Palaniswami

these officers serving under a government? The change in governance should start with the rulers,” the former Chief Minister said. It was a “matter of shame” that someone responsible for maintaining law and order was trying to evade responsibility, he said. The AIADMK leader questioned the delay in the launch of the Singappen Special Task Force. “Did you compromise on the sa-

fety of the women of Tamil Nadu so that you could attend the function of your secretary? Should the safety of women wait till next week,” he asked. “Should people die till you complete your six-month crash course on how to govern? Can no one question you?” Mr. Palaniswami said. Referring to the arrest of two TVK workers, who were allegedly involved in the sexual assault on a woman in Thoothukudi district, he said, “How many ruling partymen have been involved in various offences, and have been arrested in the past three weeks? As the leader of a party who could not control his partymen, how can he administer the police force? How will this government protect the people? How will it ensure the safety of women,” Mr. Palaniswami asked.

Two TVK
men arrested
for sexually
assaulting
jobseeker

The Hindu Bureau
THOOTHUKUDI

The Srivaikundam All Women Police have arrested two TVK functionaries for allegedly sexually assaulting a jobseeker after giving her a soft drink laced with a sedative drug. The police said a 33-year-old woman from a village in Srivaikundam Taluk had approached the TVK's Thoothukudi West District Youth Wing organiser Balamurugan, 29, of Arumugamangalam, and Jayapaul, 27, a TVK functionary from Ramanathapuram, for a job. The accused took the woman to a hotel at Ervadi in Ramanathapuram district two days ago. After giving her the spiked soft drink, they allegedly sexually assaulted her. The woman later filed a complaint with the Srivaikundam All Women Police. Balamurugan and Jayapaul were arrested on Monday and remanded in judicial custody.

BJP attacks TVK

Expressing shock over the incident, BJP Tamil Nadu president Nainar Nagenathan on Tuesday alleged that members of the TVK were increasingly involved in various offences. TVK president and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay should focus on maintaining law and order, he said in a social media post. TVK members were initially accused of demanding bribes, but were increasingly facing rape and murder charges, the BJP leader said. “Instead of delivering lengthy monologues, the Chief Minister should realise the significance of his post and protect the people of Tamil Nadu from his partymen. Only that will help protect law and order in Tamil Nadu,” Mr. Nagenathan said.



Former BJP Tamil Nadu chief K. Annamalai meets Union Home Minister Amit Shah in New Delhi on Tuesday. PTI

Annamalai discusses ‘future course’ with BJP leaders in Delhi

M. Soundariya Preetha
COIMBATORE

Former Tamil Nadu BJP president K. Annamalai, whose supporters feel his potential was not optimally exploited in the party since mid-2025, met with top party leaders, including Union Home Minister Amit Shah, in New Delhi on Tuesday to discuss his future political course.

Two months ago, Mr. Annamalai is learnt to have made his displeasure known to the leadership about the “raw deal” given to the BJP by the AIADMK during the seat-sharing for the Assembly election. With the BJP candidates being defeated in all but one seat, and the changed political climate in the State following the stunning debut of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam, it was speculated that he was exploring options, including charting out on his own.

On Tuesday, he separately met Mr. Shah, party national president Nitin Nabin and BJP national general secretary (organi-

sation) B.L. Santhosh in Delhi. During the meeting, he is learnt to have briefed them about his assessment of the political scenario and why the BJP’s performance was below par in the election. Besides, he is learnt to have broached his future political course.

The party leadership, sources indicated, did not convey any immediate decision on the plans for him but was open to discussing a role for him. Those close to Mr. Annamalai indicated he was also willing to wait for the leadership’s decision before taking any other steps.

Mr. Annamalai, a former IPS officer, headed the BJP State unit from July 16, 2021 to April 11, 2025, when Nainar Nagenthiran replaced him.

Mr. Annamalai had unsuccessfully contested from Aravakurichi in the 2021 Assembly election and from Coimbatore in the last Lok Sabha polls. He did not contest the recent Assembly election and had identified himself as an “ordinary karyakarta”.

Shivakumar all set to take oath as Chief Minister of Karnataka

Congress likely to release list of around 15 Ministers who will be sworn in along with CM today; no clarity on Deputy CM posts yet, say sources

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The stage is set for eight-time legislator and Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee president D.K. Shivakumar to be sworn in as the 34th Chief Minister of Karnataka on Wednesday evening at Lok Bhavan, which completes the leadership transition from outgoing Chief Minister Siddaramaiah that started last week.

The names of Cabinet Ministers is likely to be released by the Congress central leadership on Wednesday. The list is expected to have between 10 and 15 members, who will be sworn in along with Mr. Shivakumar.

Speculation about the induction of new faces into the Cabinet along with those who had served under Mr. Siddaramaiah is also doing the rounds. The Cabinet is expected to be expanded after the Rajya Sabha elections. There is no clarity on the Deputy Chief Minister posts yet, sources said.

The Congress leaders attending the event include the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, the Leader of the Opposition in the Rajya Sabha, Mallikarjun Kharge, and Congress Chief Ministers V.D. Satheesan (Kera-



Banners installed on Lok Bhavan Road ahead of D.K. Shivakumar's swearing-in ceremony in Bengaluru on Tuesday. K. MURALI KUMAR

la), A. Revanth Reddy (Telangana) and Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu (Himachal Pradesh). A host of religious leaders, students, civic workers, farmers’ leaders, Dalit leaders and Kannada activists have been invited to the event.

The eve of the swearing-in saw continued deliberations by the leaders to finalise the list amid hectic lobbying for posts by the legislators in Delhi.

Both leaders, who were in Delhi since Monday, left for Bengaluru late on Tuesday night after discussions with the central leaders.

Supporters upbeat
Meanwhile, posters and buntings were put up by Mr. Shivakumar’s supporters across Bengaluru.

The event at Lok Bhavan itself will be low-key, though Mr. Shivakumar’s

supporters, particularly in his home town Kanakapura, are expected to hold big celebrations. Traffic restrictions have been put in place in Bengaluru, particularly in Central Business District area.

The outgoing Chief Minister, Siddaramaiah, was on Tuesday appointed as A member of the Congress Working Committee (CWC), the highest decision-making body in the party.

The party seems to have accommodated the veteran OBC leader after he paved the way for a smooth transition of power to Mr. Shivakumar. While Mr. Kharge is the president of the Congress, Jairam Ramesh and Syed Naseer Ahmed are members of CWC from Karnataka. B.K. Hariprasad, MLC, is a permanent invitee.

Naidu calls for NDA coordination during SIR

The Hindu Bureau
VIJAYAWADA

Describing the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls as a crucial exercise, Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister and Telugu Desam Party (TDP) national president N. Chandrababu Naidu on Tuesday directed the party cadre to take the exercise seriously, saying that it would test the organisational strength and coordination of the ruling alliance.

Addressing a workshop on the SIR at the TDP headquarters in Amaravati, which was attended by MLAs, MPs, MLCs, constituency in-charges, observers and Booth Level Agents (BLAs), Mr. Naidu emphasised the importance of ensuring accurate voter enrolment and verification.

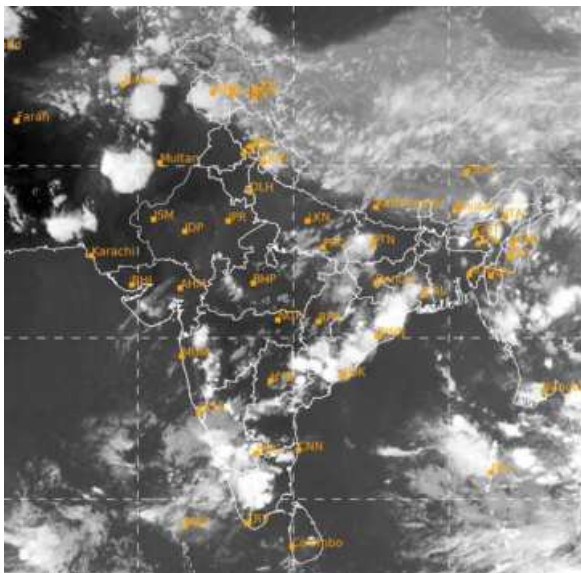
The TDP national president said voter list revision is a critical component of electoral preparedness and noted that the SIR exercises are generally undertaken once every two to three decades.

Mr. Naidu urged the TDP functionaries to ensure that all eligible voters were enrolled and that no negligence was shown during the process. While registering to vote is the responsibility of citizens, he said, creating awareness about voter enrolment is a fundamental duty of political parties.

Mr. Naidu credited the NDA’s landslide victory in the 2024 elections to effective voter mobilisation.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



Forecast for Wednesday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Arunachal Pradesh, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Kerala, Mahe and Lakshadweep. Hot and humid weather likely at isolated places over Assam, Meghalaya, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Odisha and Konkan & Goa

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		36.6	26.6	Kurnool		40.6	29.2
Ahmedabad	7	37.0	22.7	Lucknow		38.8	26.0
Aizawl	6	31.5	22.9	Madurai		38.0	25.6
Bengaluru		32.2	22.8	Mangaluru		33.4	24.8
Bhopal		37.0	22.0	Mumbai		36.4	28.6
Bhubaneswar		38.9	28.0	Mysuru	2	32.2	20.8
Chandigarh		38.0	23.2	New Delhi		37.7	26.8
Chennai		40.1	29.4	Patna		39.0	28.6
Coimbatore		36.0	24.6	Port Blair	39	28.6	24.9
Dehradun	0.2	35.0	21.0	Prayagraj		38.8	26.4
Gangtok	8	25.6	16.3	Puducherry		36.3	28.2
Goa		35.5	28.0	Pune		37.5	27.1
Guwahati		35.6	26.9	Raipur		40.5	28.0
Hubballi		33.0	24.0	Ranchi		35.0	22.0
Hyderabad		38.5	27.3	Shillong		26.4	17.0
Imphal	1	29.1	21.7	Shrimla	3	29.2	16.0
Jaipur		35.6	24.2	Thiruvananthapuram	2	32.1	25.8
Kochi	4	29.6	25.4	Tiruchirappalli		38.5	27.0
Kohima		26.0	18.0	Vijayawada		40.0	28.0
Kolkata		36.8	28.9	Visakhapatnam		35.0	27.5
Kozhikode	16	31.4	25.0				

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE
Ahmedabad	69	44	47	72	84	
Bengaluru	9	16	44	59	141	
Chennai	5	14	52	41	123	
Delhi	30	28	39	114	124	
Hyderabad	15	14	36	62	91	
Kolkata	8	23	19	83	100	
Lucknow	12	11	46	90	77	
Mumbai	29	6	14	61	68	
Pune		23	129	28	72	
Visakhapatnam	22	63	14	66	131	

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Sawai Madhopur, Rajasthan recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 214 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Nalbari, Assam recorded a healthy AQI score of 23

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)
SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.
NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.
CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.
PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Respite from heat



A brief spell of rain brought down the temperatures in Vijayawada on Tuesday. Andhra Pradesh has been reeling under an intense heatwave for the past few weeks, with temperatures touching over 45 degrees Celsius. K.V.S.GIRI

Aadhaar not mandatory for admission to schools, says Kerala education official

M.P. Praveen
KOCHI

The Deputy Director of Education (DDE), Ernakulam, has issued a strict directive to Assistant Education Officers in all 14 education sub-districts across the district to ensure that no student is denied school admission for want of Aadhaar.

Any move to prevent enrolment falls foul of the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, which mandates free and compulsory education for all children aged six to 14, the order said.

Plight of migrants
The move comes a day after *The Hindu* reported



While students can be enrolled without Aadhaar, they will not get free uniforms or noon meal.

that around 88 migrant children were denied admission to schools for various reasons, primarily the absence of Aadhaar.

The Kochi-based Centre for Migration and Inclusive Development could enrol only 38 out of the 126 mi-

grant children it identified for enrolment during this academic year.

“Apart from the general directive, specific instructions will be issued to schools accused of denying admission to children for not having Aadhaar cards. In addition, details have been sought from schools regarding students enrolled without Aadhaar, so that arrangements can be made to provide them free textbooks,” said Subin Paul, DDE, Ernakulam.

While students can be enrolled without Aadhaar cards, they would not be eligible for benefits such as free uniforms, textbooks, and midday meals.

Meanwhile, hurdles remain in enrolling migrant

children for Aadhaar cards, which are necessary to make them eligible for benefits.

Previously, schools could arrange Aadhaar enrolment, but this is no longer the case.

District Child Protection Office (DCPO) sources said that high-level intervention would be required to resolve the matter.

“Even at a meeting organised in connection with Roshni, a project for the educational uplift of migrant children, before school reopening, the District Collector had made it very clear that no student should be denied school admission on the ground of not having Aadhaar,” sources said.

Ansiba Hassan files a second complaint

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

Actor and former joint secretary of Association of Malayalam Movie Artists (AMMA) Ansiba Hassan has lodged a plea with the Infopark police in Ernakulam district, Kerala, against AMMA executive committee member Tini Tom over communal and derogatory comments against her.

This was her second complaint against former colleagues in the AMMA’s executive panel. She had petitioned the Chief Minister, the Home Minister, and the State Police Chief against AMMA vice-president Lakshmi Priya, accusing her of filing a fabricated case with the Tripunithura women’s police station.

Pawan Kalyan declares Jana Sena Party will contest Telangana elections in 2029

Ravi Reddy
HYDERABAD

Jana Sena Party (JSP) president and Andhra Pradesh Deputy Chief Minister Pawan Kalyan on Tuesday made a dramatic announcement that his party would contest the Telangana Assembly elections in 2029, turning a denied public meeting into a political flashpoint.

Speaking at a press conference from his Jubilee Hills residence, Mr. Pawan Kalyan forcefully asserted that the JSP would not retreat from Telangana. He dared his detractors to “touch him”, equating their threats to the intimidation he faced from YSRCP in Andhra Pradesh. “Is Telangana your *jagir*? I



JSP chief K. Pawan Kalyan addressing the press at his residence at Jubilee Hills in Hyderabad on Tuesday. SIDDHANT THAKUR

stay here, you can come and attack me,” he declared, insisting that his love for Telangana was longstanding and not politically opportunistic.

The JSP chief accused Congress leaders of indulging in divisive rhetoric and urged the Centre to inter-

vene. He said the manner in which his detractors were targeting him required national attention, as such comments were intended to create differences among people. He demanded accountability from Congress leaders, questioning how they

could oppose his entry into Telangana when leaders like Indra Gandhi, P.V. Narasimha Rao, Rahul Gandhi, and Priyanka Gandhi had contested from constituencies outside their home States without any controversy.

In his address on the Telangana Formation Day, Mr. Kalyan targeted the Congress while praising BRS founder K. Chandrabhekhar Rao, notably avoiding any reference to the BJP. He insisted that JSP would never be intimidated by threats or criticism. “If I was afraid, would I have started a party at all in Hyderabad?” he asked. He emphasised that even if opponents cursed him, “Telangana will remain in my heart.”

CPI(M) slams Kerala Minister for appointing brother-in-law as additional private secretary

The Hindu Bureau
KANNUR

The appointment of Benny Thomas, brother-in-law of Kerala Electricity and Parliamentary Affairs Minister Sunny Joseph, as additional private secretary to the Minister has triggered a political controversy, with the CPI(M) demanding clarification from the Chief Minister and the Congress leadership.

Mr. Thomas, a native of Ulikkal and district-level Congress functionary, was included on the first list of 13 appointments to the Minister’s personal staff. The list also includes Youth Congress leader Sudeep



Sunny Joseph

James from Kannur, while the remaining members have been appointed on deputation from government service.

CPI(M) Kannur district secretary K.K. Ragesh alleged that the Minister had turned governance into a

family affair by appointing a close relative to a key post. He urged the Chief Minister to intervene and sought the Congress’s stance on the issue.

The controversy has gained attention because the Congress had vehemently opposed a similar appointment during the tenure of previous LDF governments.

Defending the appointment, Mr. Joseph told *The Hindu* that Mr. Thomas had decades of political and organisational experience. The Minister maintained that there was no rule barring the appointment of relatives to personal staff positions.



Changed arrangement Siddaramaiah gave way to Shivakumar in a tightly managed transition

The most prominent face of the Congress in Karnataka, D.K. Shivakumar, is set to realise his long-held ambition of becoming Chief Minister on June 3. By passing the baton from Karnataka’s longest-serving Chief Minister, Siddaramaiah, to Mr. Shivakumar, the Congress appears to have resolved a grievance among his supporters, who believed that he deserved the post when the party returned to power in 2023 after leading its poll campaign as State unit president. Evidently, the Congress national leadership appears to have managed the transition in Karnataka better than it did in Rajasthan and Punjab in 2020-21, where its decisions – retaining Ashok Gehlot despite Sachin Pilot’s rebellion (2020) and replacing Amarinder Singh with Charanjit Singh Channi (2021) – failed to yield dividends in the Assembly elections. The Congress high command has also carried out the change of guard in Karnataka with an eye on the 2028 Assembly elections. There are symptoms of anti-incumbency sentiment acquiring more strength. As the Congress has chosen Mr. Shivakumar, a Vokkaliga, to succeed Mr Siddaramaiah, the BJP-Janata Dal (Secular) alliance is likely to face the poll together, as otherwise, the two parties gain little politically. Besides, the JD(S)’s top leaders belong to the Vokkaliga community and Mr. Shivakumar has been engaged in a decades-long contest with them for influence over the community, especially in the Old Mysuru region.

If the Congress and Mr. Shivakumar play their cards well, they could break Karnataka’s 35-year record of voting out incumbent governments. Having successfully handled political crises, Mr. Shivakumar should by now have a plan for winning in 2028. He must also carry all sections of the party with him and adopt a consultative approach to major policy decisions. Despite implementing several welfare and populist schemes, Karnataka has maintained fiscal discipline under the Congress government. In the just concluded FY2025-26, revenue deficit, at about ₹19,500 crore, is the lowest among similarly placed southern States. While this offers some consolation, Karnataka’s total revenue receipts grew by a modest 6.3%. Reducing stark inter-regional disparities should be a priority. In 2024-25, Bengaluru Urban district contributed about 40% of Karnataka’s GSDP, while Dakshina Kannada and Belagavi accounted for 5.3% and 3.9%, respectively. Uneven regional development can be seen in the Human Development Index too – Bengaluru Urban with 0.738, while Yadgir (0.538), Kalaburagi (0.539), and Raichur (0.562) are at the bottom. At a time when States, especially those under non-BJP parties, are facing shrinking fiscal and development space, their Chief Ministers should focus on addressing the chronic issues that affect the underprivileged. Mr. Shivakumar’s experience can help him fulfil this responsibility.

Brand value RCB helped IPL’s latest edition build on previous successes

Derided for not matching potential with performance in the past, Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB) emphatically put those old ghosts to rest. Having won the Indian Premier League (IPL) title last year, RCB did one better this year, and retained the championship. A commanding display over Gujarat Titans in the final at Ahmedabad’s Narendra Modi Stadium on Sunday ensured that RCB joined the likes of Chennai Super Kings (CSK) and Mumbai Indians, teams that have won the title for two consecutive years. Ever since the league’s inception in 2008, the Bengaluru squad tended to flourish in spurts and then fade away. Three finals were made too prior to 2025, and in all those summit clashes, RCB choked. Last year, however, a turnaround was effected but as Rajat Patidar’s men exulted, the moment turned tragic with 11 fans losing their lives in a stampede outside the M. Chinnaswamy Stadium in Bengaluru. In the latest edition, RCB maintained remarkable consistency and while Patidar marshalled his resources, Virat Kohli, Bhuvneshwar Kumar, Krunal Pandya and Josh Hazlewood chipped in. Fittingly, Patidar dedicated the triumph to the 11 fans who passed away. Meanwhile, Titans led by Shubman Gill, ran into a stronger outfit in the final and could not cash in on the advantage of playing at their home ground.

Having commenced on March 28, the IPL with 10 teams and 74 matches, had a bloated air and at times viewer interest dipped. The cricket, though, was from the top-drawer of T20 cricket as batters muscled sixes. The leading star was Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, who belied his 15 summers. The Rajasthan Royals’ player is one for the future and there is talk of the selectors fast-tracking him into the national squad. Just as Sachin Tendulkar made his international debut at 16, Sooryavanshi too seems set to join that space of young talent pursuing higher glory. For now, a spot in T20I beckons even as the youngster is keen to play Tests too. Just as RCB, Titans, Sunrisers Hyderabad and Rajasthan Royals made it to the play-offs, legacy units such as CSK, Mumbai Indians and Kolkata Knight Riders fell by the way-side. A churn is on the cards and Rishabh Pant has already relinquished his captaincy with the Lucknow Super Giants. India, the reigning T20 champion, has enough talent as was evident through the IPL. The club against country debate too stirred up as England speedster Jofra Archer’s IPL contract overlapped with the one that he has with The England and Wales Cricket Board. The IPL is a massive sporting brand but it should not cannibalise traditional cricket.

When Luo Zhaohui, then China’s Ambassador to India, revived the idea of an “early harvest” in India-China boundary negotiations in 2017, India responded with scepticism. The proposal – to settle the Sikkim boundary in isolation from the three other sectors – was an asymmetric concession dressed up in the language of progress. India has resisted it. There is now a gnawing doubt as to whether it can hold that position. The trigger for this piece is a former border negotiator’s concern that India might “stumble” into a damaging course of action under Chinese pressure and driven by the temptation to project contrived progress. Diplomacy that trades long-term strategic interests for short-term optics is self-defeating.

New Delhi must be cautious

The readout issued by the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) on the 24th round of the Special Representatives’ Dialogue on the Boundary Question between India and China (on August 19, 2025) between National Security Adviser Ajit Doval and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi recorded India’s agreement to “set up an Expert Group ... to explore an early harvest in boundary delimitation in the India-China border areas”. China’s own readout was more pointed: it used the term “demarcation” rather than “delimitation” and spoke of “launching boundary demarcation negotiations in sectors where conditions are ripe.”

The MEA press release on the 35th Meeting of the Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination on India-China Border Affairs, held in Beijing on May 27, 2026, mentions that the two sides “discussed issues pertaining to delimitation, border management, mechanism building and cross-border cooperation” and “agreed to work together to make substantive preparation” for the next SRs’ meeting. The reference to ‘delimitation’ is significant as it suggests follow-up discussions on the understanding “to explore Early Harvest in boundary delimitation”.

The cornerstone of Special Representative negotiations is the Agreement on Political Parameters and Guiding Principles, signed on April 11, 2005. Article III explicitly envisages “a package settlement” covering all sectors of the India-China boundary. It establishes a three-step process: first political parameters, then a framework for a final settlement, then delineation and demarcation. Demarcation – placing physical markers on the ground – comes last, not first. China’s proposal to begin demarcation in a single “ripe” sector inverts this sequence and, in effect, asks India to abandon the package architecture in exchange for the appearance of progress. India should decline.

Why does the package settlement matter so much? Because the four sectors of the



Ashok K. Kantha

Former Ambassador to China, Subhas Chandra Bose Chair Professor of International Relations, Chanakya University, and Distinguished Fellow with the Vivekananda International Foundation

Diplomatic optics must not dictate India’s boundary negotiations with China

India-China boundary are strategically interlinked, requiring give and take across sectors. It also guards against China extracting concessions sector by sector. An early harvest in Sikkim, where India holds comparative geographical advantage, would let Beijing bank a settlement on its preferred terms while leaving the other three sectors unresolved.

The Sikkim stakes

The Sikkim Sector boundary is not, as sometimes claimed, a simple matter. Clashes at Nathu La and Cho La in 1967, with heavy casualties, showed how sharp these differences are. Article I of the 1890 Great Britain-China Convention identifies “Mount Gipmochi on the Bhutan frontier” as the starting point of the Sikkim-Tibet boundary, but it is preceded by an assertion that the boundary “shall be the crest of the mountain range separating the waters flowing into the Sikkim Teesta and its affluents from the waters flowing into the Tibetan Mochu”. China reads the article as placing the trijunction at Gipmochi. India and Bhutan hold that the trijunction lies at Batang La, some 6.5 kilometres to the north, on the watershed – which is the operative geographical principle in Article I.

Zompelri (or Jampheri) Ridge adjoining Geymochen commands a direct view of the Siliguri Corridor, the narrow strip connecting mainland India to its northeastern States. Any settlement implicitly endorsing the Gipmochi trijunction would hand China a legal instrument to press its claim to the very edge of the Himalayas, exposing the Corridor. The Chinese objective is to deepen and widen its Chumbi Valley and increase pressure on India’s most acute territorial vulnerability.

The Doklam dimension reinforces this concern. Since 2017, China has systematically consolidated its position in western Bhutan – building roads and military facilities, constructing villages including Pangda on the Amo Chu river, and developing routes to the Jampheri Ridge that bypass the 2017 Doklam standoff site. A Sikkim settlement would immediately be leveraged by Beijing to step up pressure on a vulnerable Bhutan to settle its boundary with China. India and China have agreed that trijunction points must be finalised in trilateral consultation with all countries concerned. Even if the trijunction point is left out, China could force Bhutan to settle the rest of the disputed boundary on its own terms and present India with a *fait accompli* in Doklam.

Since the Eastern Ladakh transgressions of 2020, China has pursued multiple pressure tracks simultaneously: military consolidation along the Line of Actual Control (LAC), steady resurrection of the “Zangnan” (South Tibet) narrative to describe Arunachal Pradesh, renaming of places in Arunachal Pradesh, and expansion of “border defence villages” close to India-China LAC.

U.S.-Iran negotiations, still a road to nowhere

For nearly half a century, relations between Iran and the United States have oscillated between overt hostility and crisis management. Periods of confrontation were punctuated by brief diplomatic openings, only to be followed by renewed distrust and, more recently, war and devastation.

In this context the current move towards a memorandum that could lead to an indefinite ceasefire and buy time to address the thornier issues bedevilling their relationship appears to be a significant step. However, even agreeing on a framework to enter into substantive negotiations has been far more difficult than anticipated thanks to vastly different expectations of the two sides.

The cost of conflict

What motivated Washington and Tehran to enter serious negotiations is the high cost in political and economic terms for both of renewed long drawn-out hostilities.

The U.S. attacked Iran in cohort with Israel believing that the damage inflicted by superior military force would compel Tehran to accept fundamental constraints on its nuclear and missile programmes. Iran assumed that strategic resilience, regional networks, and its capacity to threaten energy flows would impose unbearable costs on its adversaries.

Neither side fully obtained its objective. Iran suffered severe damage to parts of its military infrastructure and further economic deterioration. However, it retained sufficient capabilities to continue imposing costs through asymmetric means such as closing the Strait of Hormuz, attacking America’s allies in the Gulf and threatening continued instability in the region through its proxies. The danger of a prolonged conflict affecting shipping routes and energy markets created domestic and global pressures on Washington for de-escalation.

There is, therefore, an unusual convergence of interests that has motivated both to look for ways



Mohammed Ayoob

University Distinguished Professor Emeritus of International Relations, Michigan State University, and author of ‘The Many Faces of Political Islam’ (2020)

A ceasefire may emerge, but lasting U.S.-Iran peace remains elusive

to bring hostilities to an end. Memoranda are easier to sign than peace agreements. They are often signed precisely because they defer tough decisions. However, in this case, even signing a memorandum appears elusive because of the wide gap between the two sides.

Hurdles to lasting peace

Several obstacles stand in the way of transforming the proposed U.S.-Iran memorandum even if it is signed into a lasting peace agreement. The first concerns mutual distrust. Decades of confrontation have created deep suspicions. Iranian leaders remain convinced that Washington ultimately seeks regime change and will use negotiations as a ruse for launching attacks as it did in June 2025 and February 2026. U.S. President Donald Trump’s habit of blowing hot and cold further complicates the problem. American policymakers continue to suspect that Tehran uses negotiations primarily to buy time, preserve its nuclear option, and rebuild its missile and other delivery capabilities.

Second, any agreement will face opposition in both countries. In Washington, critics are already warning against repeating what they consider the perceived weaknesses of the 2015 nuclear agreement. In Tehran, hard-line factions, including many in the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC), will portray compromises as surrender under pressure.

The third and perhaps most serious obstacle involves regional actors, especially Israel. Israel has consistently viewed Iran’s missile and nuclear capabilities as the greatest threat to its aspiration for regional dominance. Israeli security thinking has historically favoured preventive measures that are designed to ensure that adversaries do not acquire capabilities that threaten its military superiority. In the case of Iran, this concern centres on preserving Israeli monopoly of nuclear weapons in West Asia.

Israel need not oppose peace directly. It may instead seek to shape its terms in ways that make

The resumption of Special Representative talks is welcome, but dialogue must be conducted with strategic clarity, not under diplomatic pressure or for the optics of progress. Three principles should guide India’s approach.

First, hold the 2005 Agreement’s framework firm. The Expert Group agreed upon in August 2025 must not become a vehicle for an early harvest in Sikkim. Agreeing to “explore” is not a commitment to accept. India should reject a standalone Sikkim delimitation or demarcation exercise.

Second, make peace and tranquillity on the LAC the non-negotiable condition of progress. China has periodically attempted to delink border management from the broader relationship; India has resisted this, and should continue to do so. Unilateral alterations to the LAC cannot be normalised. Indeed, the so-called “buffer zones” in Eastern Ladakh must not be allowed to persist.

Third, press for genuine political engagement on a comprehensive settlement. Decades of talks have shown that the respective narratives cannot be reconciled through legal arguments. The 2005 Agreement recognised this: it called for a political settlement that would “safeguard the vital interests of both countries” and set out principles such as the two sides “safeguard(ing) due interests of their settled populations in the border areas”. Any breakthrough requires political will on both sides. India should press for meaningful boundary negotiations, not paper over the lack of progress with working groups. The test of China’s seriousness will be whether it is prepared to engage on the framework for a comprehensive settlement – and whether it is prepared to hold the LAC stable while that engagement proceeds. Absent those conditions, the Special Representative process risks becoming what it has sometimes been before: a forum for managing appearances while China improves its position on the ground.

Stay the course

In boundary talks, China has a track-record of cherry-picking and resiling from formal commitments, as it did in the case of an explicit agreement to arrive at a common understanding of the LAC after exchanging maps showing the entire alignment. India must prevent the Agreement On the Political Parameters and Guiding Principles for the Settlement of the India-China Boundary Question from meeting a similar fate. If peace and tranquillity on the LAC is the foundation for rebuilding India-China relations, the 2005 Agreement is the road map for resolving the boundary question. India has nothing to gain from an early harvest limited to Sikkim and must maintain its negotiating space through a comprehensive negotiation. India cannot afford a shortcut to a destination that suits China.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

A crisis of confidence

A prestigious school education board of India has suddenly found itself in the eye of the storm following the introduction of an ‘on-screen marking’ system. Change is necessary and inevitable, but implementing reforms without adequate safeguards can be risky.

Years of good work can be overshadowed by a single act of neglect. The future of students is at stake, and parents are being subjected to tremendous stress. The doubts cast on the evaluation system could linger in the minds of students for years. The Education Ministry must undertake a thorough

review of the system and work diligently to restore the confidence of students and parents.
Balasubramaniam Pavani,
Secunderabad

Fair play needs planning
Congratulations to Royal Challengers Bengaluru on a memorable IPL title triumph. Their consistency

and performances throughout the tournament deserve appreciation. At the same time, one cannot help but feel for Gujarat Titans. The team arrived in Ahmedabad late at night before the match and had very little time to recover and prepare. Following the game, they also had to contend with unexpected

logistical difficulties and disruptions. While such challenges are part of professional sport, adequate rest and smooth travel arrangements are essential to ensure that teams compete on as level a playing field as possible. As the IPL continues to grow, tournament organisers should consider

scheduling and travel-related factors more carefully so that the quality of competition is determined primarily by performance on the field.
Bhavleen Saini,
Mohali, Punjab

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the full postal address.

How land pooling solves acquisition woes

Rajasthan has recently announced the State's first land pooling scheme. The government is optimistic that the scheme will help with land acquisition and deliver the land needed for roads, infrastructure, and development activities. Other States, too, are either actively thinking of implementing land pooling schemes. While States such as Gujarat and Maharashtra have found success, much will depend on localised innovation and institutional flexibility.

Urban infrastructure projects in India have historically relied on land acquisitions. This process has become increasingly complex and financially burdensome, particularly after the enactment of the Right to Fair Compensation and Transparency in Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement Act, 2013. The limitations of land acquisition are both structural and procedural. Even before the 2013 Act, acquisition processes were time-consuming and often contested. Post-2013, the inclusion of rehabilitation and resettlement provisions have further increased financial obligations, making large-scale acquisitions for urban infrastructure increasingly unviable. This has resulted in a growing gap between planned infrastructure and its implementation. Plans are often under-executed due to the inability to mobilise land.

On pooling land

While States have tried different solutions, land pooling mechanisms, especially Town Planning (TP) schemes, have emerged as a viable alternative. In a land pooling model, landowners voluntarily contribute land for infrastructure development and receive a portion of the serviced land in return. This method reduces the need for compulsory acquisition and distributes development benefits among stakeholders.

The TP scheme, widely



Amit Gotecha

An urban planner advising various State governments on town planning schemes

Compared with land acquisitions, town planning schemes reduce displacement, ensure equitable benefit-sharing, and enable faster urban development

implemented in Gujarat and Maharashtra, is among the most successful land-pooling models in India. Under this model, landowners voluntarily contribute about 25-40% of their land to provide infrastructure such as roads, parks, public amenities, and housing for economically weaker sections. The remaining land (60-75%) is returned to them as reconstituted plots that are better shaped, serviced, and more valuable. This method integrates land assembly, infrastructure provisions, and cost recovery.

A key strength of the TP scheme is its participatory, people-centric approach. It is also financially self-sustaining, as incremental charges from landowners are recovered during development rather than up front. Compared with land acquisitions, TP schemes reduce displacement, ensure equitable benefit-sharing, and enable faster urban development while preserving environmentally sensitive areas. Recognising its potential, the Government of India has promoted TP schemes since 2019.

Land pooling is, however, not a new idea. For instance, in Gujarat, it was introduced almost 100 years back and formalised under the Gujarat Town Planning and Urban Development Act, 1976. And over time, in Gujarat, more than 1,000 sq. km across Ahmedabad, Surat, Rajkot, Vadodara, and Gandhinagar have been planned through TP schemes.

But unlike Gujarat, Maharashtra failed to update its statutory provisions for enabling TP schemes over time. However, Pune and the Mumbai Metropolitan Region Development Authority have recently adopted this model again to provide infrastructure and serviced land in the city's peripheral areas.

Exemplary model

While other States have tried to implement the model, it has not been easy. For example, in Guwahati, even though the Guwahati Metropolitan

Development Authority Act, 1985 included provisions for the preparation and implementation of development schemes, it lacked clarity on critical aspects, including the percentages for land appropriation and institutional roles. An equally significant challenge was the absence of digitised land records; land records in Guwahati were maintained manually. Additionally, discrepancies were observed between revenue records and ground conditions.

To address this, rather than conducting time-consuming joint measurement surveys, the existing map was retained as is, and final plot allocations were based on the land areas specified in the revenue records. This significantly reduced the time required to prepare the scheme. Reducing landowners' contribution was another key decision to make the scheme more acceptable. Private landowners were asked to contribute only 12-15% of their land, compared with the usual 35-45%. This was primarily used for road infrastructure.

In Rajasthan, land pooling had already been recognised in statutory provisions since 2016. However, they were handicapped by a lack of experience. Now, modifications are being made to the land-value calculations in the State to ensure that the financial burden on landowners remains manageable. The government has absorbed a portion of the cost, making the scheme more equitable and attractive.

States that are just about to venture into land pooling, such as Tamil Nadu, Madhya Pradesh, and Delhi, also have to go beyond conventional approaches. Their challenge is to first convince landholders, communicate the benefits, and contextualise the approaches. Particularly, factors such as legislation on land-pooling requirements, adjusted land-contribution mechanisms, and equitable financial models will collectively determine the success of TP schemes.

Need to strengthen existing health facilities

The famed public healthcare model of Kerala is under tremendous stress

STATE OF PLAY

K. S. Sudhi

The newly sworn-in United Democratic Front (UDF) government in Kerala has announced its intention of setting up two more medical colleges in the State, one in Thiruvananthapuram, which already has a medical college, and another one in Haripad, in Alappuzha.

UDF leaders view the second medical college project in Thiruvananthapuram, which was originally launched during the tenure of Congress Chief Minister Oommen Chandy, as a prestige issue as the subsequent governments of the Left Democratic Front (LDF) shot the plan down for political reasons. The Congress, which is back in power in the State after a decade, is bent on resurrecting its lost dream, which it believes would increase its public appeal and political stake in the capital city. K. Muraleedharan, the State Health Minister, has made it clear that nothing could prevent the UDF government from creating two more such institutions.

Those who argue for the two medical colleges say that there is little scope for expanding the facilities at the existing Thiruvananthapuram and Alappuzha colleges. The government is toying with the idea of converting existing hospitals into tertiary care and research centres, they say.

Interestingly, the second medical college in Thiruvananthapuram, which would be set up by developing the General Hospital, is located in the Vattiyoorkavu Assembly constituency, which is represented by Mr. Muraleedharan. Similarly, Harippad, the seat of the proposed second medi-



cal college, is represented by Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala, the second-in-command in the State cabinet.

Like in Thiruvananthapuram, the proposed medical college in Harippad could well be considered as the second such institution in the coastal district of Alappuzha, as the first one is functioning at Vandanam, located almost an hour away from the constituency of the Home Minister.

Desperate conditions

Kerala, along with other States, had joined a campaign of the Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare a few years ago to have new medical colleges in all its districts. It appears that the State Health Minister has overlooked the fact that Kerala has one medical college each in all of its 14 districts, and that many of them, which were inaugurated at least a decade ago, are still in their nascent stage. With little infrastructure, an insufficient number of teaching faculty and support staff, and a large number of patients, some of the medical colleges in the less developed regions of the State need support desperately.

The government's move to have one more medical college in the two districts seems to be a case of misplaced priorities with respect to public health. Several public health experts have been sounding the alarm that the

famed public healthcare model of Kerala could collapse at any moment due to the tremendous pressure under which the system is functioning, and the lack of adequate government patronage in the form of timely recruitment of staff, financial support, and upgradation of facilities. While setting up new institutions may earn the government brownie points, it could come at the expense of the existing institutions of the State.

It is also time for the State government to ponder why the younger generation of doctors are turning away from medical colleges. Besides the comparatively poor pay, lack of modern research and medical facilities, and the uncertainties of transfers and political interventions in the service, might be acting as a deterrent for such youngsters. The medical and the non-medical staff are being overworked in these hospitals, which has hit the efficiency and quality of the services offered to the general public.

During the second term of the LDF government, it was the Health Ministry that came under severe public criticism. From building collapses to doctors taking to social media to vent out their despair regarding the absence of essential facilities including surgical materials for performing crucial surgeries, shortage of medicines, wrong diagnoses and complaints of medical negligence, the crisis in the health sector played a significant part in turning public opinion against the previous government.

Strengthening the existing network of public healthcare institutions, and not building new ones, should be the priority at this juncture in the State.

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The finish line is still far for Indian sprinting

Gurindervir Singh's national-record, 10.09s, ranks 524th on the all-time list; only 39 countries have broken the 10-second barrier

DATA POINT

Devvyanshi Bihani

By the time the men's 100m final began at the Federation Cup in Ranchi on May 23, 2026, India's national record had already changed hands twice within that tournament – a first in Indian sprinting. A day earlier, Gurindervir Singh had lowered the national record to 10.17 seconds in the first semifinals. Minutes later, Animesh Kujur reclaimed it with 10.15 seconds in the second semifinal. Gurindervir seized the opportunity the final offered. His time of 10.09 seconds not only restored the record to his name but also made him the first Indian to break the 10.1-second barrier.

The achievement marked the latest chapter in a rivalry that is transforming Indian sprinting. Anil Kumar's national record of 10.21 seconds had remained unbeaten since 2000. By clocking 10.18 seconds, Animesh not only broke that in July 2025, but became the first Indian to cross the 10.2-second barrier.

While it took 25 years for Indian men's sprinting to breach the 10.2-second barrier, it has seen a dramatic leap forward since then. With Gurindervir's 10.09 seconds, followed by Animesh's 10.15 and 10.18 seconds, and Manikanta Hobliidhar's 10.19 seconds, four of the five fastest 100m sprints by Indian men have been recorded in the last two seasons. But where does India's fastest-ever sprinter stand in the global arena?

An analysis of World Athletics' all-time men's 100m lists shows both the significance of Gurindervir's breakthrough and how far India remains from sprinting's elite. On the global all-time list, Gurindervir's record ranks only 524th.

At the very top, the sport remains remarkably concentrated. Ten of the top 11 performances belong to sprinters from just two countries – Jamaica and the U.S.

Jamaica's Usain Bolt holds the world record at 9.58 seconds. American Tyson Gay shares the second-fastest time in history at 9.69 seconds. The only exception is Kenya's Ferdinand Omanyala, whose 9.77-second run shares the 10th place (**Chart 1**).

The sub-10-second barrier remains one of athletics' most exclusive benchmarks. More than half a century after electronic timing became the standard in 1968, only 39 countries have produced athletes with 100m runs recorded under 10 seconds (**Chart 2**).

Martin Owens, Animesh's coach, told *The Hindu* that breaking that barrier requires far more than raw speed. "You need natural talent. You need good facilities. You need good recovery and medical backup. You need an intelligent programme," Mr. Owens said, adding that coaching from an early age, financial support and international exposure are also crucial.

When every country's fastest man ever is compared, India sits at around 65th among 182 nations. Several nations with populations under 1.5 crore rank ahead of India, including Trinidad and Tobago, Botswana and Namibia.

It is notable that the fastest sprint performances are usually recorded with a helping breeze. An analysis of the best performances from these 182 nations shows that 139 were achieved with tailwinds between 0.1 and 2 metres per second, while only 17 came while facing headwinds (**Chart 3**). Even slight wind assistance matters in an event decided by hundredths of a second.

Four of India's top five performances, including Gurindervir's, were recorded with tailwinds. However, his national record came with a relatively modest breeze of 0.3 metres per second, indicating scope for faster performances under more favourable conditions.

Gurindervir, after setting the new record, told the media that the world would soon see Indians running below 10 seconds.

Off and running

The data for the charts were sourced from World Athletics, the international governing body for the sport of athletics

TABLE 1: The top five Indian men's 100m performances

India Rank	World Rank	Competitor	Time (in seconds)	Wind (in m/s)	Date of performance
1	524	Gurindervir Singh	10.09	0.3	May 23, 2026
2	878	Animesh Kujur	10.15	0.3	May 22, 2026
3	1180	Manikanta Hobliidhar	10.19	-0.6	September 28, 2025
4	1362	Anil Kumar	10.21	2	July 5, 2000
5	1480	Tamilarasu Senthilkumar	10.22	0.2	August 20, 2025

CHART 1: The all-time top-700 men's 100m performances

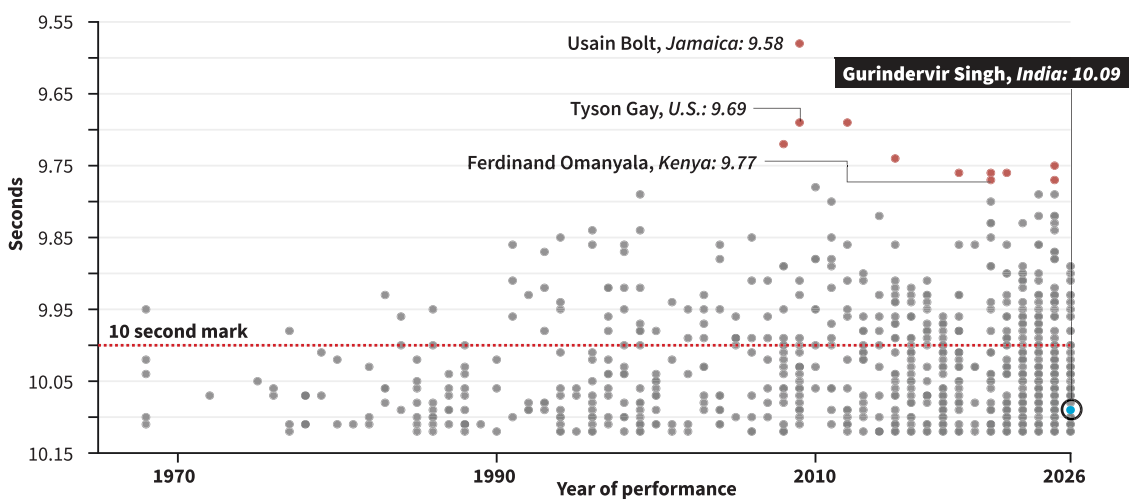
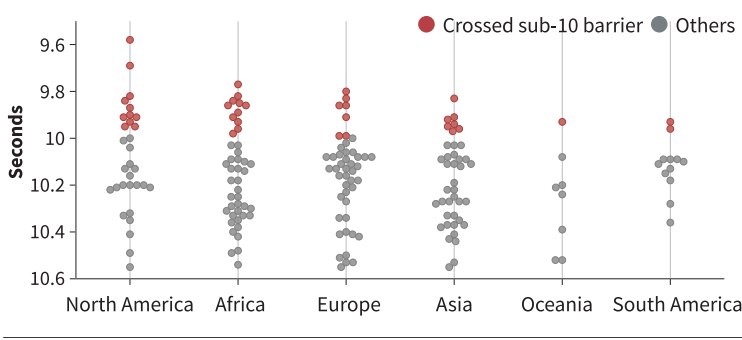
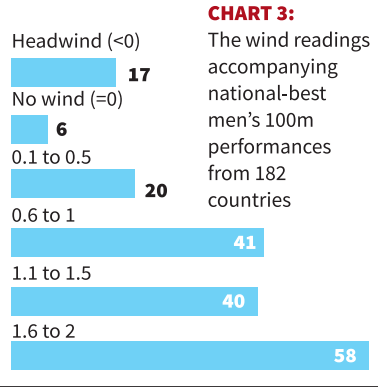


CHART 2: Fastest men's 100m performances of each country, grouped by continent and whether the 10-second barrier has been broken



During his celebrations, Gurindervir Singh held up the back of his bib, which said, "Task is not finished yet." RITU RAJ KONWAR

India Top 10 Others



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The *Hindu*

FIFTY YEARS AGO JUNE 3, 1976

Cyclone brings heavy rain to Bombay

Bombay, June 2: Bombay and suburbs were lashed by heavy rain and gusty winds since the early hours of this morning.

A spokesman of the Colaba Observatory told THE HINDU that the rains were due to the influence of the cyclone centered at 180 km in the Arabian Sea west of Bombay.

The rain abated this afternoon and this came as a relief to thousands of commuters anxious to reach home.

Between 2 a.m. and 8:30 a.m. to-day Colaba recorded 30.2 mm of rainfall. Santacruz 3.8 mm and Worli 18 mm –FOC

Samachar reports:

The movement of ships in and out of Bombay harbour was affected and rail communications slightly disrupted following heavy rain. The trains started running behind schedule following the snapping of overhead cables at a point near Andheri. There was no disruption of traffic on Central Railway. The Colaba Observatory in a late night bulletin said "very high to phenomenal" seas were likely and a storm surge six metres above the normal astronomical tide might also prevail. The storm was likely to move in a north-northeast direction along the South Gujarat coast.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO JUNE 3, 1926

League Council on opium

Geneva, June 2: "Britain is poisoning the world with its drugs", exclaimed Chu, the Chinese representative on the League's Advisory Committee on Opium.

Sir Malcolm Delevinge (Britain) had complained that 200 kilograms of morphine and heroin had been shipped to Shanghai from Germany, the Chinese Government certifying that those drugs were intended for medical purposes in Shanghai hospitals, whereas they were destined for other usages and, despite Britain's representations in this regard to the Chinese Government, the consignment had been released. This brought forth Chu's exclamation above mentioned. He protested excitedly against the alleged attack on his Government and added that the anti-British feeling in China was increasing daily.

M. Bourgeois (France), presiding, cut the lively incident short and announced tea interval.

WWS

The Hindu Huddle to look at Aravallis, Nicobar, and India’s development debate

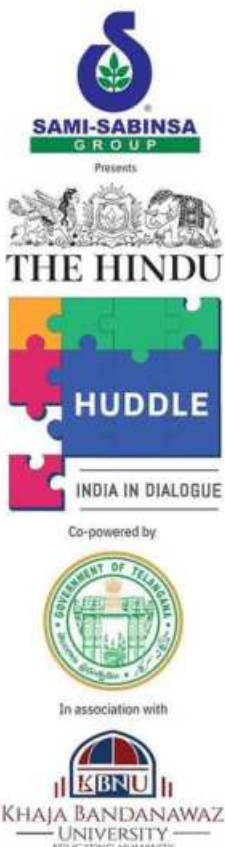
The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

One of the most defining policy debates of our time is that of development versus environment. With India pursuing various infrastructure and economic goals, there is worry that environmental concerns may not be receiving the attention they deserve.

These issues will be explored in a panel discussion at The Hindu Huddle in Bengaluru on June 6. The session will feature Jairam Ramesh, former Union Environment Minister and Congress MP, and Dr. Krithi Karanth, conservation biologist and CEO of the Centre for Wildlife Studies. The discussion will be moderated by Gargi Rawat, Consulting Editor, NDTV.

The conversation will focus on two contrasting landscapes: the Aravalli range and Great Nicobar Island. The Aravallis, among the world’s oldest mountain systems, have long faced pressure from mining and quarrying. In 2025, after widespread protests, the Supreme Court froze new mining leases in notified areas across Delhi, Haryana, Rajasthan, and Gujarat. The ruling has been seen as an important step towards protecting a fragile ecosystem that plays a crucial role in groundwater recharge and combating desertification.

Meanwhile, the Great



Nicobar, known for its unique biodiversity and indigenous communities, is the site of a proposed ₹72,000-crore infrastructure project aimed at creating a transshipment and defence hub. While supporters view the project as strategically important, critics have expressed concerns about its ecological impact.

The discussion will examine what these two landscapes reveal about environmental governance in

India today. It will also explore whether citizen activism can influence conservation outcomes, how policymakers should assess projects involving irreversible ecological losses, and why environmental issues, such as the pollution crisis, rarely become major electoral concerns.

At the same time, it will acknowledge India’s conservation successes, including its network of tiger reserves, national parks, and wildlife sanctuaries. The discussion and questions will centre on how India can balance growth and environmental concerns in the years ahead.

Event partners

The Hindu Huddle is presented by Sami-Sabinsa Group as the Presenting Partner.

The event is vo-powered by the Government of Telangana and held in association with Khaja Bandanawaz University.

The event is further supported by: Bank of Baroda, Larsen & Toubro, Apollo Hospitals, IIM Sirmaur, ICFAI Group, TAFE, Uttarakhand government, Wizzmon, Associate Partners; Casagrand, Realty Partner; Toyota, Luxury Car Partner; Amity University Bengaluru, University Partner; Harrow International School Bengaluru, Education Partner; Meghalaya Tourism, State Partner; NDTV 24x7, TV Partner.

Exam lapses have contributed to growing public distrust: ABVP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad, the student wing of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh, has expressed concern over irregularities in the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (Undergraduate), Common University Entrance Test and UGC-NET, stating that repeated lapses have undermined confidence in the country’s ex-

am system. The lapses have led to growing distrust among students, parents and the public, it said.

Odisha resolution

In a resolution adopted at its National Executive Council meeting in Odisha from May 29 to 31, it blamed administrative failures, inadequate security safeguards, weak infrastructure and poor accountability. The resolution said

several initiatives aimed at improving transparency and quality in education had been launched in recent years. Shortcomings in implementation have limited their impact, it said.

It urged the Centre and the States to work jointly to ensure effective implementation of education reforms. It called for adequate resources, stronger institutional accountability and timely execution of policy measures.

Former Trinamool MLA, KMC councillor arrested in Bengal

The Hindu Bureau
KOLKATA

Arrests of Trinamool Congress leaders continued on Tuesday, with former Kalna MLA Debaprasad Bag and Kolkata Municipal Corporation councillor Sachin Singh being taken into custody in separate cases of alleged corruption and extortion.

Since the BJP came to power in West Bengal, nearly a hundred Trinamool Congress leaders, mostly local-level workers, have been arrested over allegations of corruption and post-poll violence linked to the 2021 Assembly elections. According to the police, Mr. Bag was arrested after huge quantities of government relief materials were found at his house.

“We are not yet sure why he stored such a huge quantity of government relief materials at his house. We are probing whether he was planning to sell them or had any other plans,” Amarjit Biswas, an officer at Kalna police station,

Nearly a hundred Trinamool leaders have been arrested since the BJP came to power after polls

said. The police said that local residents also questioned his “luxurious lifestyle”.

The Narkeldanga police arrested KMC councillor (ward 36) Sachin Singh over allegations of extortion, bribery and intimidation by local residents.

Former Katwa MLA Rabindranath Chattopadhyay was hospitalised on Tuesday after he was allegedly attacked by BJP workers over accusations of misappropriating relief materials.

Meanwhile, resignations kept pouring in from Trinamool Congress leaders over the past few days. On Tuesday, Member Mayor-In-Council in KMC Tarak Singh resigned from his post, citing “mental disturbance” and lack of proper responsibilities.

INDIA bloc to meet on June 8 amid strain; Trinamool expected to attend

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

Leaders of the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA bloc) are set to meet here on June 8. Trinamool Congress president and former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee, who has often maintained a distance from the Opposition bloc, is expected to attend.

Attention will also be on the DMK, which is upset with the Congress after it snapped ties and allied with the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam to join the government in Tamil Nadu. Earlier, DMK Lok Sabha leader Kanimozhi had written to Speaker Om Birla requesting that her party members be allotted seats away from the Congress in the Lok Sabha.

According to sources, 17 Opposition parties are likely to attend the meeting. Participants are expected to include Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah and Jharkhand Chief Minister Hemant Soren. Ms. Banerjee



Big meeting: Trinamool Congress chief Mamata Banerjee and Congress leader Rahul Gandhi at an event. FILE PHOTO

is likely to be accompanied by her nephew and Trinamool national general secretary, Abhishek Banerjee. Several Opposition parties had recently rallied behind Mr. Banerjee, criticising the BJP over an attack on him in West Bengal.

Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav, RJD leader Tejashwi Yadav, and Shiv Sena (UBT) chief Uddhav Thackeray are expected.

The Aam Aadmi Party, which severed ties with the INDIA bloc nearly a year

ago, is unlikely to attend, particularly as the Congress remains the principal Opposition in Punjab, the only State where the AAP is in power.

Bid to project unity

The last time top INDIA bloc leaders shared a common platform was in December 2023, ahead of the Lok Sabha election, when they had agreed to field a common candidate against the BJP in each Lok Sabha constituency – an arrangement that did not work in several States. Since then,

while the bloc has met on multiple occasions to strategise inside and outside Parliament, its top leadership has not come together. The meeting assumes significance considering the series of setbacks the Opposition parties have faced in Assembly elections since June 2024.

The June 8 meeting is seen as an effort to project unity. “It needs to be reiterated every now and then that the BJP has only 37% of the vote, while the remaining 63% of Indian voters are represented by other parties,” a senior Opposition leader said.

The bloc is also expected to fine-tune its pitch on the Election Commission, particularly in the backdrop of the Supreme Court’s validation of the special intensive revision exercise.

According to sources, leaders may also sharpen their campaign around the economic slowdown, an issue repeatedly flagged by Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi.

CBSE portal for re-evaluation faces many glitches on first day

16,000 students applied for reassessment till Tuesday afternoon, the Board says; several Class 12 students share screenshots reporting a range of technical errors; malicious actors tried to disrupt services through a barrage of cyberattacks, CBSE says

Maitri Porecha
NEW DELHI

Up to 16,000 students applied for re-evaluation of their Class 12 answer papers till Tuesday afternoon after a dedicated portal for the submission of the application was opened earlier in the day, the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) said.

The portal will remain open till the midnight of June 6, it said. Applications are being submitted for verification of issues observed in the scanned copies of answer sheets and re-evaluation.

The CBSE opened the portal after a delay of a day from the promised June 1. Despite glitches, the CBSE said “no offline applications will be accepted”. Requests submitted after the scheduled date and time will not be accepted, the Board said.

On the first day, several Class 12 students shared screenshots reporting a range of technical errors and evaluation discrepancies.

After filling out their login credentials (roll number, date of birth) and the captcha code, students were met with the message: “Verification failed, please check details”.

Heavy server traffic caused the website to become unresponsive mid-process. Many students reported that after selecting their subjects or punching in details, the page froze entirely or redirected them to a completely blank screen, forcing them to start over.

The new user interface was reportedly broken on mobile devices, including overlapping text and unclickable buttons, which was distressing for students trying to complete the process on their phones.

Service disrupted

“The CBSE revaluation portal is currently supporting over 8,000 concurrent users. As of 3:00 pm today, more than 16,000 students have successfully completed



Thousands of students had applied for re-evaluation of answer books in the CBSE Class 12 exam. PTI

ed their submissions,” the CBSE said. “While thousands of students accessed the CBSE re-evaluation portal [on Tuesday], malicious actors attempted to disrupt services through a barrage of cyberattacks. Most recent being a denial of service attack attempt causing 1.5 million hits on the portal within a matter of 2 minutes and more than 1 lakh attempts of unauthorised file access,” the CBSE further said in its official statement.

“Based on student feedback, we have further refined the platform, including extending session time limits to make the process more convenient and seamless,” the Board said.

“Students may apply online for resolution of issues observed in the supplied scanned copy of answer book, including missing pages, missing supplementary sheets, missing maps/graphs, blurred pages, incorrect answer book, or evaluation against a different set,” it said in its statement.

“Multiple issues and subjects may be selected in a single application. If students are not satisfied with evaluation they can apply for this facility,” the statement further said.

Students may also apply online for re-evaluation of one or more questions across one or more subjects by providing the required details, including question number, and page number. They are re-

quired to ensure all intended requests, across subjects, are included before the final submission.

Aadhaar for log-in

Students have been instructed to enter their Aadhaar number for logging into the portal.

“Aadhaar verification has been included for security reasons. For children who do not have Aadhaar, the parent’s, relative’s or guardian’s Aadhaar details may be used. In this case, the name in Aadhaar, date of birth, and gender must be of the person whose Aadhaar number is used,” an official said.

Legal experts have said that the Supreme Court has held mandatory Aadhaar authentication to be unconstitutional.

“Firstly, Aadhaar cannot be made mandatory. Adding a layer of Aadhaar verification adds some friction to the IT portal, but any impersonator who wants to enter the portal via social engineering can get in by defrauding someone to obtain their Aadhaar details and spoof the system,” a cyber security researcher and privacy advocate told *The Hindu*, requesting anonymity.

Once the ‘Freeze’ and ‘Proceed to payment’ button is clicked, the details are locked and cannot be edited, the Board said. Students have been advised to ensure all details are correct.

Teen flags CBSE OSM tender irregularities before House panel

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Sarthak Sidhant is too young to be elected to Parliament, but the 17-year-old student from Jharkhand, who flagged alleged irregularities in the Central Board of Secondary Education’s (CBSE) tendering process for the On-Screen Marking (OSM) system, presented his findings before a parliamentary committee on Tuesday.

The Standing Committee on Education, Women, Children, Youth and Sports, chaired by Congress MP Digvijaya Singh, met to discuss the “use of On-Screen-Marking in Grade 12 CBSE exams and issues faced by students”.

Submits document

Mr. Sidhant, who appeared for the Class 12 exams this year, submitted a seven-page document outlining alleged anomalies in the CBSE’s tendering process for selecting vendors for online marking and posed a series of questions to the Board, sources said.

His presentation was



Sarthak Sidhant arriving at the Parliament House Annexe in New Delhi on Tuesday. ANI

made in the presence of CBSE Chairman Rahul Singh and School Education Secretary Sanjay Kumar, along with other officials from the Education Ministry and Board. Mr. Singh was transferred hours after the meeting.

The CBSE, meanwhile, submitted a report to the panel detailing challenges involved in implementing the OSM process. Officials, sources said, assured MPs that issues with the portal had been resolved and that students now have time until Saturday to apply for re-evaluation of answer sheets.

NSUI moves HC, seeks enquiry into OSM row

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The National Students’ Union of India, student wing of the Congress, on Tuesday moved the Delhi High Court seeking an independent enquiry into the alleged large-scale irregularities in Central Board of Secondary Education’s (CBSE) On-Screen Marking system for Class 12 exam.

The PIL also seeks manual rechecking and physical verification of answer

sheets of aggrieved students. The plea is likely to be heard by a Vacation Bench on June 8. It sought a direction to the authorities to keep its portal open for verification and revaluation of answer sheets for one month.

The plea said those whose answer sheets were affected by scanning defects, mismatch errors or other technical failures cannot be made to suffer because of deficiencies in the system.

Rahul hails unity in Rajasthan Cong., calls it example for others

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Pradesh Congress Committee (PCC) chief and the Congress Legislature Party leader holding hands can be a good example for other States, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi said in Rajasthan, conveying a message to other States.

He made these remarks in Pushkar on Monday, where he had gone on the concluding day of a 10-day training camp for district presidents under the Sangathan Srijan Abhigyan.

While receiving Mr. Gandhi at the airport, PCC chief Govind Singh Dotasara and CLP leader Tika Ram Jolly jointly offered him a bouquet, prompting him to make the remark. “A very good example for all other States,” he said.

His remarks are significant against the backdrop of intense rivalry between former Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot and his former deputy Sachin Pilot a few years ago.

The comment is not on-

ly an acknowledgement of factional feuds in the party but also conveys a sense of urgency in settling them after the leadership transition in Karnataka.

Leadership tussle

On June 4 and 5, Mr. Gandhi will be visiting Uttarakhand, a State the Congress is looking to wrest back from the BJP in next year’s Assembly polls.

However, before then, the high command has to ensure that all the top leaders are on the same page. And like in other States, former Chief Minister Harish Rawat, CLP leader Priyam Singh and PCC chief Ganesh Godiyal are in a leadership tussle.

The situation in Punjab, another State where polls are to be held next year, is worse as rivalries are spilling into the open. A three-cornered contest has emerged among Leader of Opposition Partap Singh Bajwa, State party chief Amrinder Raja Warring and former Chief Minister Charanjit Singh Channi.

Business

INBRIEF



Adani group companies post record \$16-billion capex

Adani group companies reported a record capital expenditure of ₹1.53 lakh crore (\$16.1 billion) and an all-time high EBITDA of ₹94,834 crore (\$10 billion) in the 2025-26 fiscal year, underscoring an accelerating infrastructure expansion cycle while maintaining leverage below its stated target. The investment programme lifted the portfolio's gross asset base to ₹7.85 lakh crore, with nearly 80% of spending directed towards energy, utilities and logistics businesses. PTI

Oyo-parent Prism gets SEBI nod to launch ₹6,650-cr. IPO

Prism, the parent firm of global travel tech unicorn Oyo, has secured clearance from markets regulator SEBI to raise ₹6,650 crore through its initial public offering (IPO), people familiar with the development said on Tuesday. The proposed public offering is expected to value the company at \$7-8 billion, they added. Oyo's parent entity Prism filed the preliminary IPO papers with SEBI in December 2025 through the confidential route. PTI

India slips to seventh in m-cap rankings; South Korea ahead

India's equity markets slipped to seventh place in terms of market capitalisation on Tuesday as heavy foreign selling, weak earnings growth and limited exposure to AI-linked stocks allowed South Korea's chip-heavy market to overtake it. South Korean stocks have rallied this year, driven by AI chipmakers, which have lifted the combined value of companies listed on KOSPI, KOSDAQ and KONEX to \$5.01 trillion, surpassing the \$4.85 trillion value of firms on NSE. REUTERS

Extreme heat tests India's record milk production

NEWS ANALYSIS

Reuters
NEW DELHI

During a summer of extreme heat with temperature topping 40 degrees Celsius last year, much like northern India is currently experiencing, dairy farmer Neeraj Bharadwaj watched one of his cows deliver a calf months early.

The newborn was tiny and almost hairless. People said it would not survive, but Bharadwaj bottle fed it milk until it slowly recovered.

Scientists say such pre-



Heat stress reduces feed intake and diverts cows' energy.

mature births are part of a wider pattern of increasingly intense summers linked to climate change.

Bharadwaj's small farm of six cows near Delhi is typical of millions in India, the world's biggest dairy

producer responsible for almost a quarter of global supply where most milk comes from farms with between 2-5 animals.

5% of GDP

Dairy sector accounts for about 5% of India's GDP and supports more than 80 million farmers. Rising incomes and population level mean demand for dairy is set to grow - the government estimates it could almost double by 2050.

But extreme heat means cows eat less, make less milk, struggle to conceive and produce fewer live offspring, experts say, while farmers spend more

trying to keep animals cool and fertile. "Milk production falls by nearly 30% during extreme heat," Bharadwaj said.

Record output

India's milk production reached a record 239 million tonne in the 2023-24 fiscal year, up nearly 64% in a decade, according to government data.

But researchers, dairy experts and farmers say rising heat is quietly exposing the vulnerabilities of that model. Scientists at the National Dairy Research Institute said heat stress reduces feed intake and diverts cows' energy

away from milk production and reproduction.

Bharadwaj spent some ₹2 lakh modifying cattle sheds with tarpaulin covers and ventilation systems to cut heat stress while yearly maintenance added another ₹50,000.

Pankaj Navani, a dairy entrepreneur, said larger organised dairy operators adapted more quickly because they treat dairy as a commercial business, investing in cooling systems, ventilation and feed management. But such investment is hard for most dairy farmers operating with only a handful of cattle and limited capital.

'Formalising supply chain integrity a huge challenge for circularity'

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

Formalising supply chain integrity in manufacturing is a challenge for circular economy in India, industry leaders opined. At the Maharashtra Circular Economy Conclave held here, large Indian firms spoke about the efforts being taken towards circular economy, the regulatory framework and the push and pull factors towards circularity.

"There are two challenges at present. We need to have supply chain integrity. In India, we have an informal way of managing circularity. How to formalise it is a challenge. The second challenge is transparency and traceability in the system that the material is really good and is going to get recycled back into the system," said Prabodha Acharya, CSO of JSW Steel.

A panel discussion with the representatives of firms such as Mahindra Group, Tata Group, Aditya Birla Group and JSW Steel explored three broad themes on why circular econo-



A panel discussion focused on the importance of circular economy.

my mattered to large businesses, how conglomerates can shape systems beyond own operations to suppliers and what the next phase of circular business transformation in Maharashtra and India could look like. They also discussed the significance of resource security at a time of geopolitical instability, which has become a major factor leading to circularity.

Push and pull factors

Deeksha Vats, chief sustainability officer of Aditya Birla Group, emphasised on the impact of

push and pull factors in creating circularity. "The regulations are the push factors. The pull factor is when the customers ask for greener products. Currently, the need for resource security is what is leading to bigger strides in circular economy," she said.

Mr. Acharya said JSW Steel was able to use 99.99% of its waste as byproduct. "We created JSW cement to create another business. It is one of the most low-carbon businesses. Everything which comes out must be reused. Every energy which comes out, we trap and use. We do waste-gas recycling. [As much as] 40-50% of our energy needs are met out of it. We use everything that comes out of it," he said.

The event organised by the Consulate General of Finland in Mumbai, Embassy of Finland in India, MMRDA, Finnish Innovation Fund Sitra and FICCI was the official side event of World Circular Economy Forum 2026, to be hosted in Asia for the first time this year in September.

'LPG consumption fell 19% in May; petrol, diesel increased'

Consumption of petrol increased 2.8%, while that of diesel rose less than 1%, according to provisional govt. data; fall in LPG consumption attributed to increase in interim booking period

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

In the third full month of the West Asia conflict, India's consumption of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) declined more than 19% in May this year in comparison to the same period last year, according to provisional government data.

Meanwhile, consumption of petrol increased 2.8% during the reported period, while that of diesel rose less than 1%.

The provisional data from the Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell (PPAC) also pointed to consumption of aviation turbine fuel (ATF), also having dipped about 0.8% during the same period.

India consumed about 2.12 million metric tonnes (MMT) of LPG in May this year, which is about 19.2% less than 2.62 MMT it consumed in the same month



Steady go: There has been no major structural shift in LPG usage, although PNG connections have been increasing. SUDHAKARA JAIN

last year, according to the provisional data.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Prashant Vashisht, senior vice-president and co-group head of Corporate Ratings at ICRA, explained the fall in consumption is to do with the interim booking period being increased from 21 to 25 days in urban areas and up to 45 days in rural areas.

Mr. Vashist also pointed to an additional factor being the government's supply maintenance orders - allocating 70% of commercial LPG of the pre-crisis levels to ease pressure on LPG. Further, according to Abhishek Nath, Sector Head for Energy and Power at Delhi-based think tank Center for Study of Science, Technology and

Policy (CSTEP), the decline is primarily to do with supply disruptions.

"India's LPG consumption has declined in May this year mainly due to supply disruptions. There has been no major structural shift in LPG usage, although the number of piped natural gas (PNG) connections has been increasing," he stated. Mr. Nath added the disruptions have also led to people trying out electric cooking as well.

India consumed 3.89 MMT of petrol in May this year, higher than 3.78 MMT it did in the same month last year.

Meanwhile, consumption of diesel stood at 8.67 MMT in May compared with about 8.59 MMT in the comparable period last year. Specifically reflecting on diesel, Mr. Vashisht explained consumption of diesel has moved from a higher base to a slightly higher base.

ED conducts searches at Vedanta premises

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Directorate of Enforcement (ED) has initiated a foreign exchange "violation" investigation against global mining conglomerate Vedanta Group and conducted searches at its premises, officials said on Tuesday.

It is understood that the raids were launched against the business house, promoted by billionaire Anil Agarwal, on Tuesday.

"We are extending full cooperation to the authorities and are providing all information sought. The company remains committed to compliance with all applicable laws and regula-

tions. As the matter is currently under regulatory process, we are unable to comment further at this stage," a Vedanta spokesperson said. Vedanta Ltd. is a leading global producer of metals, critical minerals and technology.

The company has operations across India, Africa, the Middle East and East

Asia. ED officials said premises located in Delhi and Rajasthan apart from some other locations had been covered.

The investigation is being conducted under the civil provisions of the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA), the officials said.

(With inputs from PTI)

'War to trim 100 bps off MSME revenue'

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

The West Asia conflict will hit micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) in India hard this fiscal, impacting both revenue and profitability according to a study by Crisil Intelligence.

As per its' projections revenue growth of MSMEs will moderate to 7.5-8.5%, down 100 basis points (bps) compared with fiscal 2026, while earnings before interest, tax, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) margin will de-

cline 50-100 bps to 5-5.5%.

"The forecasts would have been more subdued but for the domestic gems and jewellery market, experiencing a value-led expansion driven by surge in gold prices. Such outsized impact, however, is not unprecedented," Crisil said.

Amid the Covid-19 pandemic, large players had seen revenue decline by 0-1% in fiscals 2020 and 2021 while MSMEs experienced a 3-5% drop. The Ebitda margin of MSMEs had also declined 80 bps to 4.7% in fiscal 2021.

HUL sets up Unilever Fragrance Hub

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Hindustan Unilever Ltd. (HUL) inaugurated the Unilever Fragrance Hub (UFH) here reinforcing India's role as a key growth market and R&D hub.

The facility is the third such in Unilever's network following the U.K. and the U.S. and is the latest investment under Unilever's overall €100 million programme to boost fragrance creation capabilities.

Office of The Urban Improvement Trust, Sawai Madhopur
क्रमांक - ८.८(1)नविवा/राकसीकी विविदा/रा.अ./2026-27/1336
राकसी - 21/05/2026
Notice Inviting Bid (04/2026-27)
Bids for Civil Work (02) is invited from interested bidders up to 06:00 PM (time) 30/06/2026 (date). Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal <http://eproc.rajabasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> of the state and departmental website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 965 Lacs.
UBN - USM2627WSOB00013 to USM2627WSOB00014
Raj.Samwad/C/26/3862
Executive Engineer

JODHPUR VIDYUT VITARAN NIGAM LIMITED
(MATERIAL MANAGEMENT & CONTRACT WING) NEW POWER HOUSE,
INDUSTRIAL AREA, JODHPUR-342003 PHONE: (0291) 2742223, FAX: (0291) 2746539
E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
E-Procurement Tenders are invited for purchase of LT XLPE Insulated ACSR Rabbit Conductor Under TN-2143 (UBN JVV2627GLOB00134).
Details regarding Quantity, Tender cost, Earnest Money, Schedule date of tender opening for aforesaid tenders are available on our website at energy.rajabasthan.gov.in/jdvvn1 and also at <http://sppp.rajabasthan.gov.in>.
Raj.Samwad/C/26/3832
SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER (MM&C)
विज्ञापन संख्या २६२७/२०२६/३८३२

Office of the Project Director
RUIDP
Rajasthan Urban Infrastructure Development Project
AVS Building, Jawahar Circle, J.N. Marg, Jaipur - 302017 Tel No: +91 141 2729665, Fax No: 0141-2721919 email : mail.ruidp@rajasthan.gov.in, web site: www.ruidp.rajasthan.gov.in
Invitation for Bids- RUIDP/RIICO/PALI/02
1. Rajasthan Urban Infrastructure Development Project (RUIDP) invites online unconditional bids through e-procurement portal <http://eproc.rajabasthan.gov.in> for Package No. RUIDP/RIICO/PALI/01 for the work of "Recycled Water Distribution Project for RIICO Industrial Area Madia Road, Pali" from eligible class contractor.
2. RTTP Act 2012 and Rules 2013 with all amendment will also be applicable.
3. Bid document for downloading would be available at e-proc website www.eproc.rajabasthan.gov.in starting from 22nd May, 2026. Deadline for bid submission up to 15:00 hours on 12th June, 2026.
4. Pre-bid Meeting for the work package will be held at 15:00 hours on 29th May, 2026. All the prospective bidders are advised to participate in the Pre-bid meeting.
5. Any addendum, clarification to the bidder's queries and corrigendum etc. will be published on the e-proc web sites and will not be published in Newspapers.
6. Bidders may contact Additional Project Director, RUIDP (0141-2548404), Jaipur for any information on bidding process.
NIB Code : UID2627A0007, UBN No. : UID2627WLOB00007
Raj.Samwad/C/26/3845
Project Director, RUIDP

E-mail ID: cebbuildings_orissa@yahoo.co.in; cebbuildings@rediffmail.com; Tel:- (0674)-2391523
OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF (CIVIL), ODISHA
NIRMAN SOUDHA, UNIT-V, BHUBANESWAR
INVITATIONS FOR BIDS (IFB)
File No. B-t-Tourism-02/2023 18630 / Bhubaneswar, the 29th May, 2026
Invitation For Bids - 2nd Corrigendum
Tender Reference No. CE-Bldg-II-04/2026-27
Name of the Works : (1) "Redevelopment Lord Gupteswar Temple in Boipariguda Block of Koraput District".
(2) "Development of Koraput Culture Centre, Koraput".
The following changes have been made in Bid Identification No.CE-Bldg-II-04/2026-27
1. Bid documents such as DTCN / BOQ etc. can be seen / downloaded from the Govt. Website i.e. www.tendersorissa.gov.in, during the period from dt.05.06.2026 to 17.00 hours of dt.19.06.2026 instead of dt.28.05.2026 to dt.12.06.2026 for ONLINE BIDDING respectively.
2. Online bids shall be received till 17.00 Hours of dt.19.06.2026 instead of dt.12.06.2026.
3. The technical bids will be opened at 11.30 A.M. of dt.16.06.2026 instead of dt.17.06.2026.
All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.
Chief Engineer, Buildings-II (I/c), Odisha, Bhubaneswar
QIPR-34001/34117/126-27/0024
34001/291/2627

Uttarakhand Tourism Development Board (UTDB)
Pandit Deendayal Upadhyay Paryatan Bhawan, Near O.N.G.C. Helipad, Nimbuwala, Garhi Cantt, Dehradun - 248003 (UK)
Ph. 0135-2559898, Fax 135-2559988
Ref. No. 1380/2-7-1020/2026-27 Dated: 02 June, 2026
UTDB invites tender for Supply of Ski Equipment to the Uttarakhand Tourism Development Board (UTDB), Dehradun, Uttarakhand
Details may be obtained on website: uktenders.gov.in and uttarakhandtourism.gov.in from 3:00 PM on 03.06.2026. Prospective Bidders may seek clarification till 03:00 PM on 07.06.2026 through E-mail: adventurewingutdb@gmail.com with CC to procurement.utdb@gmail.com. Any Addendum/Corrigendum including date extension will be uploaded only on uktenders.gov.in. Bids must be submitted online through uktenders.gov.in only. The last date for submission of bids is 30.06.2026 till 15:00 PM.
Chief Executive Officer



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

I know I am not far away from the top

After quietly climbing to World No. 40, Chotrani has his eyes fixed on the Asian Games singles gold; the 24-year-old, who is the second highest-ranked men's player in the country, feels he can improve further by working on the mental and physical aspects of his game

INTERVIEW

Veer Chotrani

K. Keerthivasan

After taking up squash full-time following his graduation from Cornell University in the USA two years ago, Veer Chotrani has emerged as one of the players to watch out for on the PSA Tour.

The 24-year-old from Mumbai has quietly climbed the PSA rankings ladder to a career-high World No. 40, registering notable wins over top players. Chotrani has now set his sights on winning the Asian Games gold medal in singles, which offers direct qualification for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics.

"If I win the Asian Games singles gold, I will clinch an Olympics berth. Nobody knows who will play in the individual events (at the Asian Games) because you have the mixed doubles event as well. But if I get a chance to play singles, it will be a pretty good opportunity," Chotrani told *The Hindu*.

He also spoke about competing full-time on the PSA Tour, the challenges a professional player faces, and his desire to perform better in Platinum events in the new season.

You are ranked 40th in the world. Are you satisfied with your season?

Yes, it was good. I've seen progress in every department of my game. I had some good wins. There were also a few matches where I didn't get the result, but I feel that my performances against some of the top players were really good. Overall, it was a positive season.

You registered some impressive wins over Abhay Singh and other higher-ranked players this season. Which performances would you consider the highlights?

I beat France's Baptiste Masotti, who was in the top 20, at the Squash on Fire Open in Washington. That was probably my biggest win... my first victory over a top-20 player. I beat Abhay twice (in the Indian Tour in Mumbai and the World championships in Giza) out of the three times we played each other. I played one of my best matches when I pushed top-10 player Joel Makin

(Wales) to five games at the New Zealand Open in Christchurch. Reaching the quarterfinals of the Hamburg Open was great.

These kinds of performances have given me a lot of confidence and motivation to keep pushing. I know that I have the potential to get up there very soon. It's just a matter of time before I put together a consistent run of good results. Hopefully, that happens next season.

Which are the areas you think you need to work on?

My game has definitely improved, but I still think there is plenty of work to do, especially on the mental and physical aspects. That is what really separates players like me from the top guys. At this level, almost every player has the squash ability to compete at a very high standard. But who is willing to push themselves physically and mentally to the absolute limit to get over the line? That is what separates the top-10 players from those ranked in the 30s and 40s.

That is something I'm working on. The more exposure I got against the top-10 and top-20 players this season, the more I learnt. It gave me a much better understanding of what it takes to compete at the highest level, something I didn't fully have before this season. Being able to step on court with someone like Makin, who is among the top players in the world and one of the fittest on the Tour, and being able to stay with him and compete was a huge positive for me. In today's game, the physical and mental sides are everything, so those are areas I really want to focus on.

Do you take advice from your father Manish Chotrani, who is a former National champion?

We only talk squash; we love the sport way too much. It's our common language. He only wants me to get better every time I'm training or playing a tournament. All the time we're just discussing what the next step should be. It's good to have someone at home who keeps a check on me. He is someone who understands me very well. It's very good to have that kind of sporting, squash

mind... someone who can analyse my game very well. He talks to my coach David Palmer and gets feedback from him. Whenever I'm in Mumbai, I'm with my dad on the court. He's the one who hits with me all the time.

All eight of your PSA titles have come at the Challenger class. Do you think you need to win Copper, Bronze and bigger World Tour events to improve your ranking further, especially with the Asian Games coming up in September-October?

Yes, all of them have been at the Challenger level, but I also made two finals (St. James Expression Open in Springfield, the USA, and the Indian Open, Mumbai) at the World Tour level this season. Obviously, the goal is to start winning World Tour titles, beginning with Copper events. I don't think that I'm too far away from that level.

There is intense competition for places in the Indian team for the Asian Games. You are the second highest-ranked men's player behind Abhay. With the rankings

getting updated every week, how difficult is it to maintain your position on the tour?

Honestly, I'm not really thinking about the rankings. I just want to focus on my preparation and game. Ramit Tandon (47) and Velavan Senthilkumar (53) and I are extremely close in the standings, while Abhay (24) is ahead of us. But I believe that on any given day, all four of us are capable of beating each other. So, I'm not really thinking too much about all of that.

India now has four men in the world's top 60...

To be honest, even before COVID-19, we had a few players in the top 50. Saurav Ghosal was obviously far ahead of everyone at that point. We also had players like Ramit in the top 50. Harinderpal Singh Sandhu, Vikram Malhotra and Mahesh Mangaonkar... all of whom broke into the top 50 at different points of their careers. Maybe it wasn't as consistent then, but Indian squash has definitely had players capable of reaching that level. Right now, we have a very healthy rivalry among the four of us. Going into the Asian Games, there is a huge opportunity for us to defend our team gold. I genuinely think we have a much stronger team and a much better chance than last time.

Who could be India's toughest opponents at the Asian Games?

Traditionally, it has been Pakistan, Hong Kong and Malaysia. That has been the case for many years, and I don't think it will change this year either. Based on world rankings, I think we have the most consistent and solid team. That makes a huge difference in terms of depth. Hopefully, we go into the Games as the No. 1 seeded team. After that, it's all about delivering on the big stage at the right moment.

In the past, you had balanced playing on the PSA Tour with college squash. How has the

transition to professional squash been?

It's been great. I've been playing full-time since September 2024. I've been competing regularly and performing well on the PSA Tour, which is the reason for my rise in the rankings. I don't think there was much pressure on me when I started playing full-time. I planned my schedule well so that I had enough flexibility to train and recover. Physically, it wasn't too taxing, but mentally, it was tougher because of all the travelling – constantly moving from one country to another, flights, hotels and adapting to different conditions.

But honestly, I had zero pressure because I felt I had nothing to lose. It was my first full season, and my only goal was to play good squash and climb as high as possible in the rankings, especially since I hadn't played many PSA events before. I also wanted to enjoy the experience – travelling to different countries, competing at different venues, in different atmospheres and in front of different crowds. It was a lovely experience, and the exposure I gained in my first season is something I'll always cherish.

Of course, there were a lot of learnings as well. Last summer, I worked extremely hard on my physical conditioning, and I could clearly see the improvements this season. I know I need to keep doing that consistently every year, and that's going to remain a major focus for me going forward.

What is your next objective?

I would love to play in the individual event (singles) at the Asian Games. It is not just about winning an Asian Games gold; there is qualification for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics, too. I would love to have a shot at that. I also aim to make it to the Platinum events next season. I need to be in the top 35 in the world to be able to get into those events. I'll be working towards that; I'm not far away.

Is there one eye on the Los Angeles Olympics?

Winning the singles title at the Asian Games is my major goal. If I win gold, I will clinch an Olympics berth. Nobody knows who will play in the individual events (at the Asian Games) because you have the mixed doubles event as well. But if I get a chance to play singles, it will be a pretty good opportunity.

India vulnerable to chronic aircraft noise thanks to regulatory gaps

Researchers have said the health effects of noise depend on how loud it is as well as on how often it occurs, how long it continues for, whether people have enough time to recover before the next exposure — especially as they sleep at night — and cumulative long-term exposure

Rohan Singh
Kushagra Rajendra
Argha Kamal Guha

Every few minutes, aircraft descend over densely populated neighbourhoods near India's major airports. For the people here, the noise has been almost constant for years, often even continuing through the night. India's aviation and environmental regulations require airports to map the aircraft noise exposure using decibel contours – maps showing how the air pressure varies around the airport. Official assessments have also identified high-noise zones extending into residential areas.

But even as India's airports monitor sound with increasing technical precision, they have paid far less attention to what years of repeated exposure may be doing to people. Research on the long-term biological effects of chronic aircraft noise in India is also limited. Some emerging research has pointed to inflammation, stress-related changes, and even cognitive effects. The fact remains, however, that the gap between regulatory noise monitoring and understanding biological risk is widening.

Aircraft noise, biological stress

The limited research available, often confined to high-intensity occupational settings such as aviation personnel, nevertheless suggests aircraft noise may have effects far beyond hearing loss alone.

One 2025 study led by Manish Shukla, a scientist at the Defence Institute of Physiology and Allied Sciences, a laboratory under the Defence Research and Development Organisation in New Delhi, checked 621 Air Force personnel who were chronically exposed to aircraft noise. The researchers found elevated levels of systemic inflammation and oxidative stress and lower heart-rate variability.

These personnel also showed subclinical cochlear and neural damage. While their standard hearing tests were normal, they had inner-ear and auditory nerve dysfunction.

Together, the findings suggested aircraft noise may be a chronic biological stressor affecting both auditory and cardiovascular systems. Dr. Shukla noted that even lower urban noise levels, when experienced over long periods, could potentially trigger similar stress-related pathways in the body.

He added that current aircraft noise assessment frameworks may underestimate broader public health risks because they remain largely centered on hearing damage and decibel thresholds. He noted that emerging evidence increasingly links chronic noise exposure to stress-related inflammation and cardiovascular effects, even at lower



The standard metrics designed for steady industrial noise don't capture the intermittent, burst-like nature of the noise from aircraft. PASCAL MEIER/UNSPLASH

exposure levels.

The current approaches to monitoring also fall short of addressing cumulative biological stress, Dr. Shukla said.

Unequal risk

The gap between monitoring noise and understanding risk requires technical but also social solutions because of how the options of the people at risk are constrained. Not all people living near airports can afford to move elsewhere or fully proof their homes from the vibrations and noise.

Rajeev Kariya, who has lived near Delhi airport flight paths for decades now, said aircraft noise has become more intense over the years as flights have become larger and more frequent and airports have extended runway operations. He said the continuous noise regularly disrupts sleep and irritates him throughout the day. He installed expensive double-glazed windows but they did little to keep the noise out. His neighbourhood, he said, is suffused with it.

Researchers have said the health effects of noise depend on how loud it is as well as on how often it occurs, how long it continues for, whether people have enough time to recover before the next exposure – especially as they sleep at night – and cumulative long-term exposure.

Both World Health Organization and International Civil Aviation Organization guidelines have acknowledged these factors.

The standard acoustic metrics are designed for steady industrial noise. They do not capture the intermittent, burst-like

nature of the noise from aircraft flying overhead. That is, each takeoff produces sudden sound peaks and that can trigger disproportionate psychological responses.

Markandeya Tiwari, a former faculty member of the Department of Civil Engineering at IIT-Banaras Hindu University, said relying only on averaged indicators, such as L_{eq} and L_{DN} , is insufficient to understand aircraft noise exposure. He added that additional metrics such as L_{10} , L_{50} , and L_{90} are required to capture fluctuations, peak exposure periods, and intermittent noise.

L_{eq} is the average acoustic energy. L_{DN} is a variant of L_{eq} over 24 hours plus 10 dB added to all nighttime noise. L_{10} , L_{50} , and L_{90} are the sound levels exceeded for 10%, 50%, and 90% of the time.

Activist Anil Sood, who has been involved in legal disputes over airport noise for nearly 17 years, has disputed whether averaged indicators can capture repeated noise peaks, night-time disturbances, and long-term exposure linked to health risks. Using RTI applications and court proceedings, Mr. Sood has questioned official monitoring methodologies and airport-noise assessments.

According to him, while the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) is formally responsible for monitoring aviation noise, most of the compliance is handled by airport operators and the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA).

Former CPCB regional director D.K. Soni said the current regulations do not adequately address the long-term public-health implications of chronic

noise. Cumulative exposure assessment, he said, remains a low regulatory priority.

CSIR-National Environment Engineering Research Institute senior technical officer Satish K. Lokhande said India's aircraft noise monitoring needs substantial improvements.

"Currently, monitoring is largely limited to regulatory compliance rather than long-term health-based assessments," he said, recommending real-time noise monitoring networks around residential and hospital zones with public dashboards.

Beyond decibels

According to Dr. Tiwari, acoustic monitoring that is mindful of fluctuations in sound levels could help identify when peak exposure occurs. That then could allow doctors and hospitals, urban planners, and architects to develop more targeted ways to mitigate noise and health-based standards for affected populations.

Taken together, the challenge now is not that data is unavailable – it exists – but that health-based evidence of harm is linked in a very limited way to aviation regulations. Until that changes, India may continue to measure aircraft noise with great precision even as it knows less and less about the noise's long-term impact.

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THE GIST

Even as India's airports monitor sound with increasing technical precision, they have paid far less attention to what years of repeated exposure may be doing to people

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BIG SHOT



A blue moon, the second full moon in a calendar month, rises behind the ancient Greek temple of Poseidon at Cape Sounion south of Athens, on May 31. AFP

WHAT IS IT?

Bolides: fireballs going boom

Vasudevan Mukunth

On May 30, a meteor exploded over northeastern U.S. while producing loud booming noises. NASA scientists said the object broke apart around 64 km above the ground as it was falling at more than 1,20,000 km/hr. The energy the explosion released was estimated to be equivalent to around 300 tonnes of TNT.

Experts often call these objects bolides. A bolide is an exceptionally bright meteor that breaks apart or explodes in the earth's atmosphere. These objects are originally small pieces of rock or metal in space that, after a close encounter with the earth, enter the atmosphere as meteors. As such a meteor falls, the air in front becomes compressed and heated, causing it to glow and produce a bright streak of light across the sky.

Most meteors are very small and burn up completely before reaching the ground. However, larger ones can survive for longer. If they become bright enough, they become fireballs. And if they fragment violently and release a large amount of energy, astronomers often call them bolides.

The rock or metal is usually some small fragment left behind by asteroids or, less often, comets. They orbit the sun until their paths intersect with that of the earth. When they enter the atmosphere, they can travel tens of kilometres every



A frame grab of a video recorded by a dashboard camera shows the Chelyabinsk meteorite descending in February 2013. AP

second. The loud booms are the resulting shockwaves.

A famous example is the Chelyabinsk bolide, which exploded over Russia in 2013, generating a powerful shockwave that damaged buildings and injured more than a thousand people.

For feedback and suggestions for 'Science', please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject 'Daily page'

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Cases filed in 50 days of J&K's campaign against drug trafficking

176 In the first 50 days of Jammu and Kashmir's campaign against drug trafficking, 176 cases were registered under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act, and 202 accused persons were arrested or detained, police said on Tuesday. The zero-tolerance policy towards narcotics has yielded significant results, Jammu SSP Joginder Singh said. PTI

The death toll from Russian strikes on Ukraine

18 The death toll from Russian strikes on Ukraine overnight rose to 18, officials said on Tuesday, hours after Moscow's forces launched hundreds of drones and dozens of missiles across the country. The mayor of Kyiv announced that six people had been killed and 66 wounded in the capital, while authorities in the city of Dnipro said that 12 people had died in the attack. AFP

Number of mortgages approved by U.K. lenders in April

65,945 The number of mortgages approved by British lenders for house purchases rose to a three-month high of 65,945 in April from 63,979 in March, according to Bank of England data on Tuesday. April's approvals were well above the 62,000 median forecast in a Reuters poll of economists. REUTERS

Eurozone inflation in May due to the war in West Asia

3.20 in per cent. Eurozone inflation rose in May as the West Asia conflict sent energy costs soaring, official data showed Tuesday, reinforcing the likelihood of an interest rate increase in the single currency area. Consumer price rises accelerated to 3.2 per cent last month, the EU's statistics agency Eurostat said, up from 3.0 percent in April. AFP

Value of defence exports by Israel in 2025

19.2 in \$ billion. Israeli arms exports have reached an all-time high for the fifth consecutive year, hitting more than \$19 billion in 2025, the Defence Ministry announced Tuesday. Missile, rocket and air defence systems were the lead exports, it said, adding that a "surge was recorded in observation and optronics systems". AFP

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The future of India's chip industry

A new NITI Aayog report says India's semiconductor ecosystem is not yet equipped to fully meet domestic demand, while stressing the need to strengthen local manufacturing, as geopolitical pressures could potentially disrupt the electronics supply chain

EXPLAINER

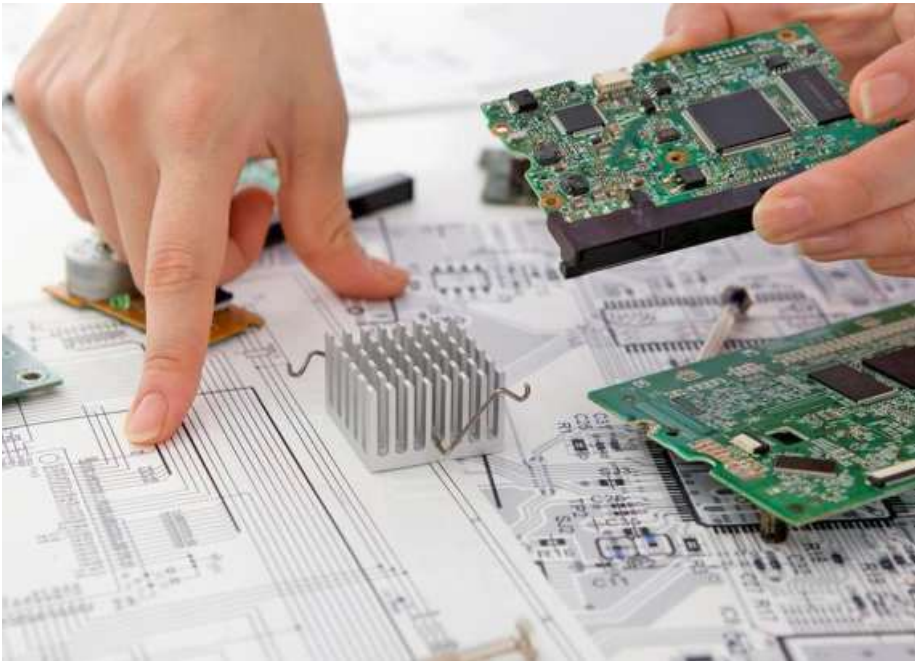
Aroon Deep

NITI Aayog's Frontier Tech Hub released a report last week that had two main messages: first, that India faces steep challenges in developing world-class semiconductor manufacturing capabilities, and second, that national interest necessitated pursuing this field doggedly regardless of those difficulties.

The Union government has made chipmaking a priority, since semiconductors are a part of nearly all electronics, from consumer gadgets to defence gear. Yet, India does not have a single fabrication unit, with the first expected to open in Dholera, Gujarat by 2028, with a total of ten in various stages of development. Multiple semiconductor packaging and testing facilities have been generously subsidised and supported by the Union government (as well as some State governments), through initiatives like the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM).

The ISM is a ₹76,000 crore corpus, and it is almost fully earmarked to projects across semiconductor fabs, incentives for component manufacturing, and bulk subscriptions to industry-grade semiconductor design applications for students and academia. While the most cutting edge and ambitious projects – fabs – have received capital subsidies of upwards of 50%, other projects have received production- or output-linked incentives.

The report, titled 'Future of India's Semiconductor Industry', reiterates that these are yet early days for the semiconductor industry, since even chips used in domestic electronics assembly operations are largely sourced from outside the country. "India's local ecosystem is not ready to fully meet domestic demand for semiconductors," the report said. But it insisted that there



GETTY IMAGES

was still a need to manufacture locally, as geopolitical pressures like a disaster in Taiwan could massively disrupt the electronics supply chain. "As many semiconductor parts used in defence systems are produced outside India, deploying them in our aerospace and defence programmes is increasing threats to national security," the report adds.

The sector "requires sustained, mission-mode commitment over a decade or more," the report said.

Fab gestation

The report points to several challenges in this indigenisation process, not least of which is the time involved. "Typically, fab units require four to five years before commencing production," the report points out. "During the gestation phase, these units need to invest in purchasing more than 50 specialised equipment from global players. Even after the production is over, processes like yield optimisation and reliability test take several quarters

before chips reach the market." Developing talent to work in these fabs is also, as a result, time consuming, the report says.

The report urges the government to work on "building sovereign design and research capabilities, R&D excellence and harnessing agentic AI for semiconductor engineering," since "building deep capabilities" in materials sciences and silicon designing will "move India from a services-led design base to a creator of differentiated IP, architectures and integration technologies that define next generation systems."

Capital investment

While the details on the second phase of the India Semiconductor Mission are yet to be revealed, the report pegs the necessary capital expenditure from the state at \$45-60 billion over a period of ten years. This amount should, however, be spent on projects where the risk is less and "bankability" can assure returns to

investors, the report warns. This translates to a shift away from directing public funds towards frontier chips, whose transistors are the smallest – 3 to 7 nanometres – and towards "mature, advanced–aligned with strategic relevance—as well as compound nodes," the report says.

The report is key in understanding the potential scope of ISM 2.0, since its ambition is defined and largely stays out of big-ticket frontier fab projects. It advocates, for instance, "selective depth, capital efficiency and system-level differentiation, rather than attempting to replicate the full global manufacturing spectrum."

For instance, packaging, which is among the last steps of a chipmaking process, and less expensive and complex than fabrication, is identified as a "core production pillar, not a downstream activity" in the report. The report calls for "[r]apid import substitution in high volume domestic segments".

Trusted partners

The report implies that China is an adversary in chipmaking in spite of the recent thaw in relations. In a list of "priority partners," the report highlights the U.S., Japan, the European Union, and South Korea as partners with whom to work to get "access to critical tools, equipment servicing and lifecycle support," and to take advantage of "India's market scale, talent base and packaging capacity."

"With sustained commitment and strategic clarity, India can build a competitive semiconductor ecosystem that strengthens economic resilience and positions the nation as a key player in the future of advanced technology," the report concludes. IT Secretary S. Krishnan welcomed the report as a "structured, actionable framework," and said in a foreword that, "India is well positioned to convert its semiconductor ambition into enduring industrial and strategic reality".

THE GIST

The Union government has made semiconductor manufacturing a priority, but India does not yet have a fabrication unit. A recent report by NITI Aayog's Frontier Tech Hub underscores the need to bolster local manufacturing.

The report urges the government to work on 'building sovereign design and research capabilities, R&D excellence and harnessing agentic AI for semiconductor engineering'.

The need for strengthening India's EV supply chains

As EV adoption gathers pace, there is a greater need to focus on reducing vulnerability to external shocks

Jaideep Saraswat
Akanksha Golchha

India's electrification of road transport has entered a decisive growth phase. Around 2.5 million vehicles were sold in FY26, a significant increase from FY25. This momentum reflects the effectiveness of policy support from both the Centre and the States, including upfront purchase incentives, road tax exemptions and other demand-side interventions. These measures helped create the initial market, reduce consumer hesitation, and establish electric vehicles (EVs) as a credible and tested technology.

Import dependence

The next phase of EV adoption demands a different policy and industrial logic. As the sector scales, India is moving away from imported fossil fuels, only to find itself becoming increasingly dependent

on imported lithium-ion batteries. The challenge is no longer how quickly India can electrify transport, but how it can do so without creating a new strategic vulnerability. EV growth must now be judged by three additional metrics: supply chain resilience, strategic autonomy, and long-term sustainability.

India's domestic cell manufacturing is still far below the scale needed to alter import dependence meaningfully. Under the ACC Battery Production Linked Incentive scheme, 40 GWh of capacity has been awarded, but only about 1 GWh has been installed so far. Meanwhile, passenger EVs sold in India are sourcing batteries from 14 global manufacturers, with 7,987 MWh imported in 2025. Of this, a significant share came from Chinese manufacturers, highlighting that increasing EV sales are tightly correlated with increasing imports from China.

This concentration creates a structural risk for Indian EV OEMs (original

equipment manufacturers). Battery supply is increasingly exposed to a single-country ecosystem that is shaped by policy, geopolitics, and industrial strategy outside India's control. Several developments in China are influencing pricing and availability, like tighter technology restrictions, prioritisation of domestic demand, withdrawal of VAT exemptions on battery exports, and more. Additionally, the West Asia conflict has compounded the pressure through higher raw material costs, elevated manufacturing expenses in China, and rising transport and risk premiums.

The consequences extend beyond OEM balance sheets. Battery inflation delays price parity with internal combustion engine (ICE) vehicles and slows the shift from early adopters to mass-market buyers. In a market as price-sensitive as India's, rising cell costs can confine EVs to premium segments and place national adoption targets at risk if the situation

persists and OEMs are forced to pass on higher costs to consumers.

This requires a holistic situational assessment and identifying key interventions in the short to medium term. The near-term response must be pragmatic. Many OEMs already talk of a "China + 1" sourcing strategy, but actual supplier diversity varies widely by segment. Higher-end EVs are increasingly paired with non-Chinese NMC batteries, while cost-sensitive mass-market models continue to rely on cheaper Chinese LFP cells. True diversification, across suppliers, chemistries, and geographies, may raise costs initially; but it significantly lowers the risk of strategic disruption over time.

Product modifications

The cost shock should also drive product-level discipline. OEMs need to design EVs around efficiency, lighter architectures, more effective drivetrains, smarter software calibration, and battery right-sizing aligned with actual usage rather than aspirational range. India's market may ultimately reward lean, purpose-built electrification over oversized vehicles designed around imported battery economics. Software-defined battery platforms that support multiple chemistries without hardware redesign would further improve flexibility as the cell market evolves. Moreover, Indian manufacturers should

begin type-testing vehicles across emerging chemistries, including sodium-ion batteries. Sodium-ion is not yet a full substitute for lithium-ion across all use cases, but it could serve as a meaningful hedge as production scales domestically, broadening the technology base and reducing dependence on any single chemistry or supplier.

Further, India's path forward lies in building a structured 'EV supply chain alliance' with trusted partners, one that spans minerals, manufacturing, technology, and standards. Such an alliance would distribute risk across geographies, deepen domestic capability over time, and ensure that no single external disruption can stall India's electrification agenda.

The EV transition is no longer straightforward and the recent disruptions underscore the need for a more resilient approach. India has already demonstrated that it can create demand for clean mobility. The next test is whether it can build the industrial depth to sustain that demand without becoming dependent on a single external bottleneck.

(Jaideep Saraswat is the Associate Director of the Clean Power, Electric Mobility & Emerging Technologies vertical at Vasudha Foundation. Akanksha Golchha is Senior Associate (non-resident) with the Chair on India & Emerging Asia Economics at Center for Strategic and International Studies.)

